AUTHORING BRIEF / 5 NOVEMBER 2026

Drakenspire

A fresh stone-built mountain city and its surrounding highlands

A complete prompt package for an image AI with no prior chat context. Includes the author brief, a copy-ready prompt, two actual art references, and the full current public descriptions of the realm, region, 59 locations and 251 areas.

LATEST DIRECTION

The compact city sits HIGH on a rocky mountain, above nearby wilderness. The fortress sits higher still. Add more densely packed stone buildings while leaving generous space for outlying locations. Use a genuinely new composition and camera, not a redraw of an older Drakenspire map.

REQUESTED OUTPUTS

1. One clean unlabelled regional map.
2. A separate locator picture using the same artwork, with clear markers and an exact-name key.

SOURCE BOUNDARY

The current canonical world supplies setting facts. Author instructions supply the new art direction. Numerical location coordinates are intentionally absent. No old Drakenspire artwork or rejected draft is included, so it cannot become an accidental composition template.

Contents: author brief; copy-ready prompt; art references; canon summary; exact location index; full location and area descriptions.

The author brief

These statements are preserved in the order given. Later clarifications control earlier ambiguity.

01

> Look at our latest file, look at drakenspire and its location descriptions, not coordinates. I want a new big map that shows more of the surrounding city in a more distinct stone style, but with the landmarks intact. Make sure to make another picture pinpointing where things are. Cause I want it to match the scale of our current Glowhaven, Akitsuhara, and Ardelis map. This could be a new perspective that doesn't follow the numerical coordinates in the file.

02

> look at our ardelis and akitsuhara map too. Those are better examples in terms of art direction

03

> just so you know, drakenspire is not that big. It's a snowy mountain city that is like uhhh fortress? And then I want space on the outer parts for the outskirts locations too

04

> I want a fresh new take on drakenspire. Not a clone drawn differently

05

> I want the city to be on a higher elevation than the wilderness in a rocky mountain with even more buildings. review the locations in the json to compile the canon locations in dragonspire as a reference first too

Interpretation for the next image

“Match the scale” means comparable regional rendering and individual building scale. It does not mean giving this small fortress-city the population or urban footprint of Ardelis or all of Akitsuhara. “More buildings” means greater density and more inhabited blocks within a compact high-elevation town. “Higher than wilderness” means visibly above the adjoining valley and lower surrounding countryside; it does not mean every distant mountain peak must be lower.

Copy-ready image prompt

Create a new, large illustrated map of Drakenspire and its surrounding highlands using only this document as context. Deliver (1) a clean unlabelled map and (2) a separate locator picture pinpointing every current location on the exact same map. Keep every established landmark and the locations' identities, but design a genuinely fresh composition and viewing direction. Do not trace or simply recolor an old Drakenspire layout. The original numerical location coordinates are deliberately omitted and must not govern the image.

Drakenspire is a compact snowy mountain fortress-city, not a vast metropolis. A higher northeastern shelf holds Crescent Crown Fortress and one immense ancestral dragon skeleton curving around its rock in a crescent. A broader inhabited shelf sits slightly below that fortress, but the CITY ITSELF is high on a rocky mountain, distinctly ABOVE the surrounding nearby wilderness, hamlet, pastures and valley floor. Both urban shelves belong high on the mountain; do not put the town down at wilderness elevation. More distant peaks can still rise higher than the city. Preserve that geographical relationship while freely choosing the camera, projection and screen arrangement. Show enough of the surrounding highland country for all the outskirts and expedition destinations; the small city must not consume the frame. Match the regional building scale and finish of the supplied Ardelis and Akitsuhara examples, not their population, urban footprint or national size.

Use the actual Ardelis and Akitsuhara images in this PDF as the main art-direction references: polished two-dimensional fantasy-anime map illustration, clear coherent building volumes and roofs, layered believable terrain, purposeful useful detail and controlled vivid color. Give Drakenspire its own strong alpine STONE identity through heavy gray/basalt masonry, substantial fortifications and retaining walls, practical slate roofs, steep cobbled lanes, warm inhabited details and natural snow. Keep the urban footprint compact, sturdy and varied, but pack MORE ordinary stone buildings into its terraces and show several inhabited blocks. Use greater density and finer building footprints rather than expanding it into a metropolis. Do not import Ardelis's extravagant palace/cathedral language or Akitsuhara's Japanese architecture.

Read every source description in the catalogue before designing. Group interior/area destinations within their parent complexes; do not turn each room or ordinary shop into a separate monumental landmark. Keep the fortress precinct coherent, the three clanholds practical, the schoolhouse medium-sized, the Cinder Pit small, the arrival portal inside a basalt hall, the onsen one modest geothermal complex, and foundries, freight, waterworks and livestock infrastructure functional. The lake is inland. Pines are limited to sheltered folds. Outer mountain country includes working and abandoned extraction, an inhabited hamlet, old settlements and ruins, exposed trails, a frozen basin, neighboring peaks, ravine and remote creature habitat. The four initially unknown sites should be unobtrusive in the clean map; their suggested placement can appear on the separate author locator.

The sacred bones are one connected dragon skeleton with one skull, distinct from masonry. They do not heat the city, generate mana or power a portal. Do not show a confirmed guardian-dragon lair, a guaranteed yeti/dragon encounter, unrelated new landmarks, a sea/coast, floating terrain, the Evertree or a huge arena. Use exterior terrain/entrance clues for underground sites, without cutaways. No title, text, names, pins, compass, frame, UI or watermark on the clean artwork. The second picture must use the very same composition, adding clear numbered markers and an exact-name key. Treat those placements as visual proposals for the new artwork, not as already-applied world coordinates.

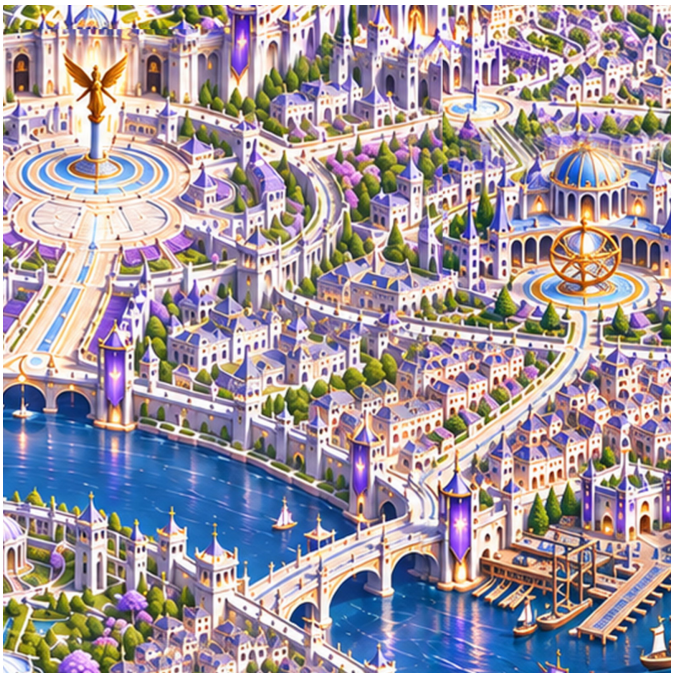
Choose a landscape canvas with sufficient resolution for a big map and a practical regional aerial perspective. Keep clear routes to gates, markets, the fortress approach, freight/craft yards, hamlet and mountain trailheads. Use crisp readable architecture, separated forms, believable stairs/supports, consistent scale and controlled snow/water surfaces. Avoid noisy microtexture, fused buildings, excessive haze and effects that hide the landmarks. Creativity belongs in the new composition, stone-built character and useful local detail; the catalogue supplies the setting facts.

Art reference 1 - Ardelis

Role: primary reference for finish, coherent architecture, visual hierarchy, material separation and readable city detail. Match its illustrated quality. Do not copy its city size, geography, palace, gold ornament or formal plan.



This overview corresponds to the current Ardelis map family. The installed central tile below confirms the same painted architectural treatment. The reference is a quality guide; Drakenspire must remain smaller, snowier and more strongly built from practical stone.



Art reference 2 - Akitsuhara

Role: primary reference for layered terrain, clear regional scale, connected routes, purposeful buildings and controlled vivid color. Do not copy its Japanese architecture, seasons, ricefields, shrines or geography.



The installed Benitsuru Basin tile below supplies a closer sample of the current map family. Use the crisp illustrated construction and depth treatment in a snowy alpine vocabulary.



Canon summary and design checks

City and elevation

One compact inhabited mountain city on a high rocky shelf, with a still-higher fortress shelf to its geographic northeast. The rotated camera may put them anywhere on screen. Nearby wilderness and lower settlements sit below the city.

The main landmark

Crescent Crown Fortress and one enormous ancestral dragon skeleton form the defining landmark. The Jarl's Hall, assembly and sanctuary belong to this one precinct. Bones are distinct from masonry.

Ordinary life

Markets, homes, small shops, three clanholds, schoolhouse, playhouse, modest fighting venue and practice grounds. Use many useful small buildings, not a collection of huge monuments.

Production and services

Metallurgy, crystal craft, freight, enclosed portal hall, one onsen, practical waterworks, stores, livestock and pasture folds. Functional roads and yards should make their relationships readable.

Surrounding country

Inland frozen lake, sparse sheltered pines, hamlet, lodge/watchpost, trails, working mine and amber cave, abandoned haul works and settlement, rocky peaks, ravine, ruins and remote habitats.

Unknown sites

First Shelter Ruins, The White Silence, Coldglass Galleries and The Fallen Pass Shrine are initially unknown. Keep their clean-map cues subtle. Their suggested positions may appear on the author locator.

Protected uncertainties

No confirmed guardian-dragon lair or visible named boss. Skeleton is not heat/mana infrastructure. Cave mouths do not reveal underground floor plans.

Current inventory

The canonical full world has 59 Drakenspire locations and 251 areas. Dusklamp Quarter occurs in historical plans, but is absent from the current canonical location collection. It is not part of this brief.

Canonical realm and region

Drakenspire Mountains

Drakenspire is an independent dragonkin-majority nation and the name of its snowy mountain capital. The city occupies two nearby elevations: a bustling inhabited shelf below, and Crescent Crown Fortress on a higher northeastern shelf. An enormous sacred dragon skeleton curves around the fortress in a crescent, joining stone walls and ancient bones into the country's defining landmark. The remains commemorate the dragon that protected the endangered founders; they do not power the city's heat or magic.

Practical alpine stone buildings, steep cobbled lanes, heavy shutters and wool-bright interiors characterize the lower city. The fortress government is sturdy rather than extravagant, while a few wealthy commercial buildings advertise private prosperity. Markets, homes, workshops, inns, a modest schoolhouse, festival streets, a small fight pit and one onsen support ordinary life. Dragon and ancestor worship shapes public customs without making every resident equally devout or every dragonkin a warrior.

A Jarl elected through the clan chiefs governs within a decentralized clan-and-chief order. Clans retain substantial influence, alongside merchants and military leaders. Drakenspire and Glowhaven are friendly sovereign partners: this country supplies excellent metallurgy and valuable magical raw materials, while Glowhaven provides enchanted goods, specialist education and other trade. The enclosed Drakenspire - Portal Room receives authorized travelers and connects to Evertree Base - Portal Room under the existing key rules.

Beyond the inhabited shelves lie lower pastures, sparse pine hollows, mines, abandoned workings, neighboring peaks and dangerous snowbound country. Some routes suit prepared fieldwork; others reach wyvern perches, giant territory or rarely visited basins. Sacred dragons discourage many threats from approaching the capital without constantly fighting on its streets. A vast gray, lightning-breathing guardian sometimes appears far overhead. His lair, the number of dragons and the full history of their generations remain unknown to the people.

Drakenspire Highlands

Drakenspire Highlands covers the capital's two snowy shelves and its surrounding mountain country across the mountain basin. The higher northeastern fortress and crescent of ancestral dragon bones dominate the skyline; the lower shelf holds the busy city. Near slopes support livestock, water infrastructure and maintained approaches. Farther routes reach sparse pines, a frozen basin, working mines, old settlements, caves, Frostback Mountain and isolated creature territories. Places within the fortress precinct are separate playable sites in one coherent complex, not detached castles. The region's existing boundaries contain these expeditions; travel within it does not invent additional regions. The enclosed portalward quarter remains the arrival point from Glowhaven.

Source provenance

File: world-draft/WorldAlpha - World.json
Snapshot date: 2026-11-05
SHA-256: 59483a52a9fb20f841300ed4db14615234d48fd0477e990712bc4093c588880c

The following source catalogue preserves public basicInfo and area descriptions. HiddenInfo, scripts, mechanics, image URLs and numerical coordinates are excluded. Source text can mention ordinary access or ownership rules; these do not become new visual landmarks. No world edits are applied by this document.

Exact current location index

Numbers identify catalogue entries and the later locator key. They are not game coordinates.

01 Drakenspire Portals
02 Embersteel Foundries
03 Stonefang Training Grounds
04 Whitepass Caravan Lodge
05 Rimecrest Trail
06 Crescent Crown Fortress
07 The Ancestor's Crescent
08 The Jarl's Hall
09 Clans' Assembly House
10 Crescent Sanctuary
11 Ancestor Cairn Terrace
12 High Rampart Gate
13 Oathward Barracks
14 Dragonwatch Balcony
15 Founders' Processional Way
16 Hearthmarket Square
17 Snowmelt Residential Steps
18 Cinderstone Schoolhouse
19 Lower Hold Gate
20 Iwatsugu Clanhold
21 Yukinose Clanhold
22 Arashimine Clanhold
23 The Hold's Judgment House
24 The Tempered Fang
25 Rivet & Rime Armory
26 The Woolen Wyvern
27 Coppercrest Exchange
28 Amberglass Assay House
29 Crystalcutters' Court
30 Resin & Root Apothecary
31 Snowchain Freight Yard
32 The Copper Ram
33 Hearthpot Stew House
34 Stonewake Onsen
35 Snowbell Playhouse
36 The Cinder Pit
37 Deepwell Waterworks
38 Hoofstep Pens
39 Woolridge Pastures
40 Winter Stores
41 Whitepass Watchpost
42 Goatstep Hamlet
43 Pinefold Hollow
44 Glassmere Basin
45 Redvein Mine
46 Lanternamber Caverns
47 The Abandoned Chainworks
48 Old Hearthfall
49 Frostback Mountain
50 The Buried Switchback
51 Skreek Crags
52 Giant's Hollow
53 The White Silence
54 Stormscar Observatory
55 First Shelter Ruins
56 The Old Offering Steps
57 Coldglass Galleries
58 The Fallen Pass Shrine
59 Rimefang Ravine

Full location and area descriptions

The canonical text below is the detailed setting reference. Use ordinary exterior cues for interior areas. Keep the latest author art direction separate from these source facts.

01. Drakenspire Portals

Initially known

Drakenspire's portalward quarter is the usual first stop in the snowy capital. An enclosed basalt transit hall opens into a compact market and communal hearth court; beyond them, steep lanes connect the lower city's homes and workshops. Above the roofs to the northeast, the fortress rises within the immense crescent of the ancestral dragon's bones. Travelers can arrange cargo, buy a hot meal, obtain directions and hear current road conditions before choosing where to go. This map location covers the arrival quarter; the wider city and nation also bear the name Drakenspire.

People associated with this place include: Fuyumi Kirihara - Portal arrivals clerk; Daigo Numata - Portal cargo porter. The authorized transit desk can approve a legitimate visit to Glowhaven and issue its reusable portal key locally. An approved journey is separate from merely standing at the arch.

Drakenspire - Portal Room

A warm vaulted basalt chamber encloses the permanent Glowhaven arch. Iron roof ribs, blue mineral veins and brass runic channels frame the crossing; frosted high windows reveal the weather. A duty desk and clear cargo floor leave passengers room to arrive. The fixed home connection returns to Evertree Base - Portal Room; its operation follows the existing route and key rules. Actual doors lead to the Cobbled Market, Hearth Court and Steep Lanes. Fuyumi Kirihara is usually based here, working as portal arrivals clerk.

Drakenspire - Cobbled Market

Low stone stalls shelter beneath striped wool awnings. Vendors sell travel food, crampon repairs and inexpensive gloves, while porters compare cargo slips. This is a small arrival market; the broader household trade happens at Hearthmarket Square. Displayed merchandise remains the vendors' property.

Drakenspire - Hearth Court

A hooded brazier warms a sheltered court with stone drains and benches cut to leave space for tails. Residents trade news beside posted local work. A traveler may eat, wait for a companion or ask directions without being drawn into an emergency.

Drakenspire - Steep Lanes

Steps and narrow ramps climb between dark stone houses with blue-gray roofs. Handcarts use the ramps; pedestrians yield at blind corners. The lanes lead into the lower city, while an uphill view repeatedly catches the fortress bones through gaps between chimneys.

Drakenspire - Cargo Recess

Iron floor rings and numbered chalk bays keep freight clear of the portal. Attendants compare declared loads with their documents before release. A torn packing label may require the owner to identify a crate; opening it or taking its contents is a separate matter. Daigo Numata is usually based here, working as portal cargo porter.

02. Embersteel Foundries

Initially known

A connected group of working foundries turns mountain ore into dependable metal stock, tools and substantial commissioned work. Soot-dark stone, extraction chimneys and sheltered loading courts make the district feel industrial without requiring every machine to be magical. Customers arrange specifications in the Commission Hall before entering supervised work areas. Drakenspire's reputation for metallurgy rests on skilled labor, careful testing and materials knowledge. The foundries supply smaller specialist workshops as well as larger orders, so a commission may involve several businesses rather than one master who does everything.

People associated with this place include: Chisato Higuruma - Embersteel foundry forewoman.

Embersteel Foundries - Commission Hall

Sample bars and finished fittings line a high room separated from the furnaces. Clerks and craftspeople translate intended use into a specification and quote. Customers can discuss repairs or deliveries without wandering into active metalworking.

Embersteel Foundries - Forge Walk

A protected walkway overlooks furnaces, hammers and crews handling bright metal. Heat, noise and moving loads demand attention. Visitors remain in marked safe spaces unless an actual supervised task takes them onto the working floor. Chisato Higuruma is usually based here, working as embersteel foundry forewoman.

Embersteel Foundries - Testing Court

A walled court holds measured loads, impact blocks and quenching stations for appropriate inspections. Tests answer a specific question about a real workpiece. Watching a demonstration does not grant the observer the item or its properties.

Embersteel Foundries - Materials Yard

Sheltered bays separate ore, scrap, fuel and finished stock. Weight slips accompany substantial deliveries. A mismatched label or poor storage can cause an expensive problem before any metal reaches a furnace.

Embersteel Foundries - Repair Bay

A quieter side bay receives damaged tools and machinery fittings. Workers separate straightforward maintenance from faults needing specialist enchantment work. Repairs are assessed, agreed and carried out rather than completed by merely discussing them.

03. Stonefang Training Grounds

Initially known

Stonefang provides supervised practice space for local fighters, guards on arranged sessions and visitors seeking instruction. It is a training ground rather than a large magical university. Its open ring, stone steps and equipment shelter support drills, sparring and practical evaluation. The ground welcomes different methods when they can be used safely in the available space; spectacular magic is not automatically suitable. Lessons and partnerships depend on the actual instructor or participant, with room for ordinary repetition and imperfect progress.

People associated with this place include: Ryōma Arashimine - Clan Arashimine heir and commissioned duelist; Tetsuya Samejima - Stonefang instructor.

Stonefang Training Grounds - Open Ring

A cleared ring accommodates supervised drills and agreed sparring. Marked edges help participants judge distance. Entering it does not start combat until the people involved have agreed what they are doing. Ryōma Arashimine is usually based here, working as clan arashimine heir and commissioned duelist.

Stonefang Training Grounds - Stone Steps

Broad steps beside the ring serve as seats and places to discuss a technique. Observers can watch without joining. A patient explanation or useful correction can be more valuable than another exhibition of strength.

Stonefang Training Grounds - Equipment Shelter

Maintained practice gear is stored under a deep roof. Items are issued for actual sessions and checked on return. Visitors do not own a weapon merely because they have been allowed to train with it.

Stonefang Training Grounds - Target Lane

A screened lane permits suitable ranged practice with clear firing and retrieval periods. Distance and backstops constrain safe techniques. Spells that exceed the facility's limits require another venue, not an implausibly indestructible wall. Tetsuya Samejima is usually based here, working as stonefang instructor.

Stonefang Training Grounds - Balance Course

Low beams and uneven stone blocks support controlled footwork drills. Snow and ice are cleared or deliberately accounted for. The course builds practical movement without being a lethal obstacle gauntlet.

04. Whitepass Caravan Lodge

Initially known

A substantial lodge near the overland approach accommodates carriers, expedition parties and visitors who need more than a quick meal. Its common hearth, route desk and covered yard connect lodging with practical travel preparation. Rooms are sturdy and warm rather than luxurious, and staff understand drying gear, early departures and delayed companions. The lodge is a useful base for mountain work without making every guest a guide or every rumor a contract. Returning safely can be reason enough for an uneventful evening here.

People associated with this place include: Natsume Hibari - Licensed mountain adventurer and expedition guide; Akemi Fushida - Proprietor of Whitepass Caravan Lodge.

Whitepass Drying-Loft Room is available by agreement: 28 marks for the quoted paid stay. Ask Akemi Fushida to inspect it and confirm the actual terms before paying.

Whitepass Caravan Lodge - Common Hearth

Long tables surround a broad hearth where wet clothing dries at a sensible distance. Guests eat stew, trade road news or sit quietly. A returning party can celebrate without the room producing a new emergency on cue. Akemi Fushida is usually based here, working as proprietor of whitepass caravan lodge.

Whitepass Caravan Lodge - Route Desk

A desk holds copied route notes, local notices and contacts for transport. Advice distinguishes maintained paths from uncertain reports. Staff can help arrange a service, but they cannot promise that a high pass is safe in changing weather. Natsume Hibari is usually based here, working as licensed mountain adventurer and expedition guide.

Whitepass Caravan Lodge - Covered Yard

Pack animals and carts shelter beneath deep eaves. Tie rails, repair blocks and water access support real travel work. Loads remain in their owners' custody, and animals are handled with permission.

Whitepass Caravan Lodge - Guest Landing

Simple private rooms open from a warm upper corridor. Quiet hours and paid arrangements keep tired travelers from disturbing one another. A closed door is not an invitation to inspect someone else's belongings.

Whitepass Caravan Lodge - Drying Room

Racks and controlled warmth dry boots, cloaks and ropes without scorching them. Labels prevent accidental swaps. Damaged gear can be noticed here before another journey, creating a practical reason to visit an outfitter.

Whitepass Caravan Lodge - Whitepass Drying-Loft Room

A warm private room with a sturdy bed, gear hooks and a shuttered mountain window above the lodge drying loft.

05. Rimecrest Trail

Initially known

A marked highland trail provides the most approachable excursion beyond the capital's immediate roads. It crosses exposed ridges, sheltered turns and places used for route and weather surveys. Prepared travelers can practice navigation, observe local ecology or carry out authorized fieldwork without immediately entering the deepest monster territory. The views are wide, but conditions can change quickly. Marker Ridge, Windbreak Shelter and Survey Shelf are established stops; pushing beyond the maintained route is a separate decision.

Rimecrest Trail - Marker Ridge

Weathered poles mark the maintained route along a broad ridge. The city remains visible in clear weather, while cloud can erase it within minutes. Travelers compare markers and footing before continuing instead of following every apparent track.

Rimecrest Trail - Windbreak Shelter

A low stone shelter holds a bench, a protected floor and a notice recess. It is a temporary refuge, not a staffed inn or limitless supply cache. A previous traveler may have left a useful dated warning.

Rimecrest Trail - Survey Shelf

A stable shelf overlooks slope, snowpack and distant animal routes. It suits careful observation and agreed field measurements. Leaving equipment or collecting specimens requires the same judgment and permissions as any actual expedition.

Rimecrest Trail - Return Junction

A marked junction points toward the lower approach and more demanding routes. Signs summarize destinations, not current certainty. Turning back here is a normal choice when visibility, gear or time makes further travel unwise.

06. Crescent Crown Fortress

Initially known

The capital's upper stronghold occupies the higher northeastern shelf, reached by a rising, guarded approach. Thick pale-gray walls, square towers and practical slate roofs enclose courts, stores and offices. An enormous dragon skeleton curves around the stronghold's outer rock, making fortress and remains a single unmistakable landmark. The Jarl's Hall, Clans' Assembly House and Crescent Sanctuary occupy distinct precincts of this larger complex. Visitors come with petitions, official business or permission to see the public courts; the fortress is a working seat of government rather than an extravagant palace.

Crescent Crown Fortress - Ascending Approach

A zigzag stone approach climbs from the lower city to the upper shelf, its parapets broken by sheltered passing bays. Couriers, carts and visitors share the route. From below, the ancestral ribs appear beyond the walls like another range of pale cliffs.

Crescent Crown Fortress - Outer Arch

A deep archway narrows entry beneath heavy gates. Guards direct public visitors toward the court and examine freight destined for government stores. Their ordinary work is traffic, access and weather readiness; a portal credential is not a fortress appointment.

Crescent Crown Fortress - Public Court

Packed snow surrounds a cleared square between administrative buildings. Petitioners wait near a roofed notice wall, while laborers cross with timber and coal. Signs and attendants distinguish the routes toward the Jarl's Hall, assembly precinct and sanctuary.

Crescent Crown Fortress - Stores Passage

A vaulted corridor connects locked grain, fuel and equipment stores. Ventilation grilles breathe cold air across numbered doors. Deliveries are weighed here, and access depends on the actual job; scarcity cannot be solved merely by declaring the shelves full.

Crescent Crown Fortress - Inner Ward

A smaller guarded court separates offices from private residential rooms. Plain windows and covered walks speak of warmth and security rather than ceremonial grandeur. Authorized messengers wait under the eaves instead of wandering into the Jarl's household.

Crescent Crown Fortress - Rampart Walk

An inspected stretch of wall overlooks the lower roofs and neighboring peaks. Public access depends on weather and duty. The sacred skeleton lies outside the masonry; nobody uses its bones as a railing or convenient source of building material.

07. The Ancestor's Crescent

Initially known

The remains of the ancient protector lie in a vast crescent around the northeastern fortress shelf. Weathered ribs rise above stone walkways, the spine follows the mountain's curve, and the skull rests on a broad natural ledge. The founders sheltered under this dragon's protection when they were close to dying on the mountain; their descendants regard the remains as sacred history. The bones define the city's silhouette but do not generate its heat or mana. Keepers maintain respectful viewing paths and support fragile sections without turning the skeleton into a public climbing frame.

People associated with this place include: Keishin Tōdō - Crescent archivist and conservator; Miharu Sakuraba - Sacred-bone conservation craftswoman.

The Ancestor's Crescent - Pilgrims' Approach

A broad stair ends at a low stone boundary where visitors brush snow from their boots. The first ribs loom beyond a turn in the path, larger than the buildings below. Keepers explain which sections can be approached safely.

The Ancestor's Crescent - Rib Walk

A paved route follows the outside of the rib cage behind a modest rail. Prayer ribbons hang from separate wooden frames, never nailed into the bones. Quiet conversation mixes with wind passing through the enormous spaces between the ribs. Miharu Sakuraba is usually based here, working as sacred-bone conservation craftswoman.

The Ancestor's Crescent - Skull Overlook

The skull lies beyond a respectful viewing distance on its rock shelf. Visitors leave lamps at a stone stand, with the fortress rising behind the curve of bone. The overlook offers no ordinary passage into the skull or beneath its unstable edges.

The Ancestor's Crescent - Spine Terrace

A sheltered terrace follows a section of vertebrae half-buried in old snow. Carved plaques recount the founders' refuge and later settlement. The path is useful for slow historical walks, remembrance and observation of the surrounding masonry.

The Ancestor's Crescent - Conservators' Shelter

Brushes, survey notes and temporary braces fill a low maintenance shelter. Keepers and stoneworkers compare cracks and snow loads before work begins. A visiting researcher can ask to examine the records; study of the remains requires actual permission. Keishin Tōdō is usually based here, working as crescent archivist and conservator.

The Ancestor's Crescent - Windward Boundary

A final low wall closes the public route before exposed scree and cliff. Warning markers are practical, not a challenge to prove devotion. Beyond it, the bones continue around the rock where only trained maintenance parties venture.

08. The Jarl's Hall

Initially known

A long, sturdy hall within Crescent Crown Fortress houses the Jarl's public business. Dark beams, clan banners and a broad central hearth provide ceremony without lavish palace ornament. The Jarl is elected through the clan chiefs rather than inheriting an unquestionable throne, and governs a country whose clans retain substantial local influence. Petitioners seek decisions on roads, trade, defense and disputes beyond a single household. Access to a hearing depends on business and availability; being an impressive visitor does not automatically secure an audience.

People associated with this place include: Daizen Iwatsugu - Jarl of Drakenspire and chief of Clan Iwatsugu.

The Jarl's Hall - Petition Porch

A sheltered porch holds benches, a public notice board and a table for sorting requests. A clerk distinguishes urgent harm from ordinary appointments. Visitors can learn the procedure without surrendering every detail of a private dispute to the waiting crowd.

The Jarl's Hall - Hearth Hall

The audience hall centers on an open hearth and raised working seat, with clan banners overhead. Hearings have witnesses, interruptions and practical limits. The room may be between sessions; an empty seat is not proof of a missing ruler. Daizen Iwatsugu is usually based here, working as jarl of drakenspire and chief of clan iwatsugu.

The Jarl's Hall - Council Chamber

A smaller chamber accommodates negotiations that need maps, accounts or difficult compromise. Thick shutters soften the wind against the fortress. Invitations matter here, and a public petition does not confer attendance at every closed discussion.

The Jarl's Hall - Records Room

Shelved copies of judgments, commitments and correspondence preserve the government's memory. Clerks retrieve relevant records according to access and condition. A public ruling can be consulted without exposing private testimony or giving visitors ownership of the documents.

09. Clans' Assembly House

Initially known

A broad stone chamber beside the fortress court provides neutral ground for the chiefs' deliberations and the election of the Jarl. Carved seats face an open speaking floor; the room is practical enough for ordinary budgeting as well as solemn decisions. Clan autonomy makes agreement necessary, while merchants and military leaders exert influence through testimony, resources and reputation. The assembly is not always in session. Residents come to hear public business, submit a grievance or learn which authority can actually resolve it.

People associated with this place include: Shūhei Iwatsugu - Clan Iwatsugu works surveyor and aspiring expedition leader; Noboru Ōhira - Clan Assembly recorder.

Clans' Assembly House - Delegates' Court

Clan messengers and witnesses wait beside stone benches and a covered water stand. Public notices identify the day's business. The court is a place for conversation and preparation, not an automatic invitation to overhear confidential bargaining. Shūhei Iwatsugu is usually based here, working as clan iwatsugu works surveyor and aspiring expedition leader.

Clans' Assembly House - Speaking Floor

A clear central floor faces the chiefs' benches. Speakers present claims, answer objections and refer to actual evidence. Disagreement can end in adjournment or compromise; every debate need not become a duel, election or national crisis.

Clans' Assembly House - Witness Gallery

An upper gallery accommodates permitted observers and people awaiting a call to testify. The low ceiling traps the warmth of the chamber below. Whispered commentary travels easily, and a visitor's interpretation is not the same as the assembly's decision.

Clans' Assembly House - Charter Room

Bound agreements, route obligations and old settlements are kept in plain cupboards. Custodians help locate a relevant clause while protecting fragile originals. Learning the law is possible here; changing a document does not change every copy or everyone's recollection. Noboru Ōhira is usually based here, working as clan assembly recorder.

10. Crescent Sanctuary

Initially known

This restrained sanctuary faces the ancestral bones from the fortress precinct. Its faith honors dragons as sacred beings and ancestors as people whose shelter, labor and choices made the present possible. Lamps, stone reliefs and woven memorial cloths fill a low, warm interior. Keepers conduct remembrance, receive offerings and teach the founding account. Outsiders may ask questions or sit respectfully without pretending belief. Religious observance shapes public life, but individual residents differ in devotion, interpretation and patience with ceremony.

People associated with this place include: Seika Amatsune - First Keeper of the Crescent.

Crescent Sanctuary - Lamp Porch

Sheltered stone niches hold lamps protected from the wind. Visitors pause here to warm their hands and ask about the day's observances. Public notices distinguish memorial gatherings from ordinary visiting hours without treating every outsider as a suspect.

Crescent Sanctuary - Hall of Refuge

Reliefs show exhausted founders beneath a protecting dragon, followed by the first shelters and workings. A central aisle leaves space for quiet gatherings. The story is told as the community's foundation, not a prophecy identifying the newest traveler. Seika Amatsune is usually based here, working as first keeper of the crescent.

Crescent Sanctuary - Offering Chamber

Covered tables receive food, cloth and other accepted gifts before their proper disposition. Keepers record significant offerings and prevent spoiled provisions from accumulating. Gifts intended for a living dragon do not guarantee that one will arrive to take them.

Crescent Sanctuary - Memorial Alcove

Small family tokens rest beside names and dates in a softly lit recess. People speak to their dead, sit silently or share a remembered meal nearby. These objects are personal memorials, not random magical treasure.

Crescent Sanctuary - Keepers' Workroom

Repair thread, festival schedules and conservation notes crowd a practical workroom. Volunteers can ask about specific tasks. The sanctuary's care includes sweeping, recordkeeping and coordination with stoneworkers as much as public ritual.

11. Ancestor Cairn Terrace

Initially known

Low cairns and family memorial stones occupy a sheltered terrace below the sacred crescent. Paths remain broad enough for winter funeral processions, with places to rest out of the wind. This is a living place of remembrance, used by clan households and residents without grand lineage alike. Visitors may trace local history through inscriptions or accompany someone paying respects. The terrace is peaceful more often than eventful; grief and ordinary care need no supernatural revelation to matter.

Ancestor Cairn Terrace - Procession Gate

A broad stone gate opens onto paths swept after snowfall. Covered benches allow mourners to gather before continuing. Flowers, evergreen sprigs and wool wraps appear according to the season and household, rather than one universal ritual.

Ancestor Cairn Terrace - Family Cairns

Low mounds and engraved stones mark generations of residents. Some names are freshly cut; others have almost weathered away. Visitors can read public inscriptions, while private grief belongs to the people present rather than to a compulsory quest.

Ancestor Cairn Terrace - Common Memorial

A plain wall remembers people whose families could not maintain a separate monument. Workmates and neighbors leave small lamps here. Its care reflects shared civic responsibility as well as religious custom.

Ancestor Cairn Terrace - Sheltered Remembrance Bench

A curved wall shields a line of benches overlooking the lower city. This is a quiet place to talk, eat a small packed meal or sit without speaking. The sound of festival drums can occasionally drift up from far below.

12. High Rampart Gate

Initially known

A fortified gatehouse controls the road from the inhabited lower shelf to the northeastern fortress precinct. It combines a switchback, inspection arch and sheltered waiting yard so winter traffic can be handled without blocking the entire ascent. Guards check appointments, dangerous loads and current restrictions. Ordinary people have business here - deliveries, petitions, repair work and religious visits - while access to military interiors remains separate. The gate's importance comes from its position, not from elaborate magical spectacle.

People associated with this place include: Reina Tachibana - Captain of the Upper Ward and fortress inspections; Hayate Mizusawa - Upper gate guard.

High Rampart Gate - Lower Switchback

A winding approach gives carts room to climb the grade without a straight charge at the gate. Snow poles mark the outside edge. People on foot use the inner steps and can see the lower city expanding beneath them.

High Rampart Gate - Inspection Arch

Under the heavy arch, guards compare visitors' stated business with the access being requested. There is room to stand aside while a delivery is checked. The inspection concerns the fortress; it does not revoke valid portal travel by implication. Hayate Mizusawa is usually based here, working as upper gate guard.

High Rampart Gate - Waiting Yard

A roofed edge of the yard shelters people delayed by weather or appointments. A brazier and posted notices keep waiting tolerable. Conversations here can reveal practical concerns, though nobody knows all government business merely from standing in line.

High Rampart Gate - Watchroom

The duty room holds route boards, spare cloaks and current orders. Entry requires a reason to speak privately with the watch. The staffing and readiness of a working gate persist after the player leaves. Reina Tachibana is usually based here, working as captain of the upper ward and fortress inspections.

13. Oathward Barracks

Initially known

Plain stone barracks house the hold's guard detachments and their equipment. A courtyard permits drill without turning the lower streets into a training ground. The force protects gates, patrols public roads and responds to violence; it is answerable to local government, not a branch of Glowhaven's strikeforce. Visitors can report danger, deliver supplies or inquire about lawful work at the duty entrance. Sleeping quarters, weapons stores and operational records remain restricted.

People associated with this place include: Gōki Shishido - Commander of the Drakenspire Hold Guard.

Oathward Barracks - Duty Entrance

A small counter receives reports, deliveries and requests to speak with the watch. Wet cloaks steam on hooks behind it. Urgency is assessed from what happened and where, with witnesses and injuries treated as evidence rather than theatrical proof.

Oathward Barracks - Drill Court

Packed gravel and snow cleared from the center leave space for formation work and practical exercises. Racks hold training equipment during supervised use. The court is a workplace, not an open arena for challenging every guard. Gōki Shishido is usually based here, working as commander of the drakenspire hold guard.

Oathward Barracks - Equipment Stores

Locked cupboards contain winter gear, maintained weapons and repair supplies. Issuing an item requires an actual assignment or authorized transaction. Issued equipment is logged, and shortages can delay an assignment.

Oathward Barracks - Mess and Rest Wing

Long tables and adjoining sleeping rooms accommodate off-duty personnel. The atmosphere is tired and ordinary between shifts. Access follows an invitation or official need; uniforms do not remove privacy or the need to rest.

14. Dragonwatch Balcony

Initially known

A broad sheltered lookout on the upper rock faces the high ranges. Residents watch changing clouds, distant wings and the paths by which trouble may approach. The gray guardian is occasionally seen far overhead, and such a sight draws serious attention, but the balcony is usually a quiet place for weather watching and conversation. It gives no view of a confirmed dragon lair. Visitors can compare sighting records, sketch the mountain skyline or simply appreciate the city below.

People associated with this place include: Kotoha Umezaki - Dragonwatch observer and weather diarist.

Dragonwatch Balcony - Wind Screen

A thick wall breaks the prevailing wind before the open viewing edge. Hooks hold communal weather notices, and a narrow bench gives tired climbers a rest. Heavy snow can make the exposed part of the balcony unsuitable for lingering.

Dragonwatch Balcony - Sky Rail

A stone rail frames the jagged skyline above the city. On a clear day a watcher can follow distant movement for a long time. No observation here automatically reveals a creature's motives, identity or home.

Dragonwatch Balcony - Sighting Nook

A dry recess holds copied reports of unusual flights, weather and mountain disturbances. Dates and witness descriptions are kept distinct from interpretation. Comparing two accounts can be useful research without proving a new prophecy. Kotoha Umezaki is usually based here, working as dragonwatch observer and weather diarist.

Dragonwatch Balcony - City View

The lower roofs, procession streets and forge smoke spread below the balcony. It is an easy place to understand the city's two elevations. The immense bones remain close enough to anchor the view without becoming a bridge between districts.

15. Founders' Processional Way

Initially known

A wide, gently stepped street cuts across the lower shelf, linking household districts with the central market and the ascent toward the sacred precinct. It is kept broad for dragon festivals, ancestor processions and ordinary freight. Wool banners and painted shutters provide color against snow and dark stone. Most days bring shoppers and deliveries; festival days bring food stalls, music and communal preparations. The street allows Drakenspire to be lively without turning every resident into a solemn warrior.

Founders' Processional Way - Banner Steps

Broad shallow steps descend between stone posts hung with seasonal cloth. Ramps along the edges carry handcarts and accommodate travelers who cannot use the steps comfortably. The posts mark a familiar meeting place rather than a formal checkpoint.

Founders' Processional Way - Procession Square

A widened section of street gives musicians and ceremonial groups room to form. Outside events, children, residents and delivery workers use the same open ground. Portable stands are stored away instead of occupying the square permanently.

Founders' Processional Way - Stall Recesses

Recessed shopfronts can hold temporary festival counters without blocking the main route. Vendors negotiate space and cleanup with organizers. On an ordinary day the recesses shelter quiet businesses and people waiting out a flurry.

Founders' Processional Way - Carvers' Corner

A sheltered corner displays repaired dragon masks, wooden ornaments and memorial boards. Artisans work on commissions in public view. Customers can discuss a design or watch careful handwork without every object being enchanted.

16. Hearthmarket Square

Initially known

The main lower-city market fills an irregular square with stone arcades and removable stalls. Butchers, wool sellers, household traders and carriers serve residents as well as visitors. Imported vegetables and grain arrive through trade alongside local meat, cheese and preserved food. The square provides shopping, small errands and news from the mountains, with public scales used to settle ordinary disputes. Its importance is daily exchange; a trip here can remain a pleasant errand.

People associated with this place include: Sachie Handa - Hearthmarket butcher; Eitarō Handa - Dairy seller and wool broker.

Hearthmarket Square - Covered Arcade

Stone arches shelter shops selling household goods and durable winter supplies. Meltwater runs in a channel outside the walking line. Customers compare quality and price while residents pause to exchange news with familiar traders.

Hearthmarket Square - Butchers' Row

Cold counters display prepared meat beside covered chopping blocks and hanging scales. Practical cleanliness matters as much as generous portions. Offcuts, orders and delivery times can support ordinary work without turning the stalls into a monster-part bazaar. Sachie Handa is usually based here, working as hearthmarket butcher.

Hearthmarket Square - Wool and Dairy Stalls

Bundles of yarn, sheep cheese and wrapped provisions share a sheltered stretch. Local households sell alongside larger traders. The scent of wool and salt is interrupted by hot broth carried through the crowd. Eitarō Handa is usually based here, working as dairy seller and wool broker.

Hearthmarket Square - Public Scales

A roofed weighing table allows traders and customers to verify substantial loads. The attendant's task is measurement, not deciding every contractual dispute. An accurate weight can still leave a question about quality, damage or promised delivery.

Hearthmarket Square - Freight Lane

A narrow service lane lets loaded carts reach the rear of shops. Pedestrians yield when a team backs into a bay. Missing labels or an overloaded cart create practical problems with recognizable owners, rather than free crates to open.

17. Snowmelt Residential Steps

Initially known

Close-set stone homes climb the lower shelf in rows broken by shared stairs and drainage runs. Shutters, wool curtains and patched roofs show households living through long winters. This is a residential neighborhood rather than a public dungeon: visitors come to meet someone, rent a room or do an agreed repair. Neighbors share snow clearance and news, with friendliness varying by person. The upper fortress is visible between roofs, but ordinary life here revolves around meals, work, children and keeping the house warm.

People associated with this place include: Atsuko Ōhira - Neighborhood clothing mender.

Snowmelt Landing Flat is available by agreement: 1100 marks for the property purchase. Ask Atsuko Ōhira to inspect it and confirm the actual terms before paying.

Snowmelt Residential Steps - Shared Stair

A broad stair passes doorways, stacked firewood and hooks for wet outerwear. Residents keep a narrow cleared line through fresh snow. Visitors can ask directions without treating each household as an open public interior.

Snowmelt Residential Steps - Drain Court

Stone channels converge beside a covered drain that must be kept clear of ice and litter. Neighbors notice leaks quickly because water reaches their thresholds. A small maintenance problem can provide useful, ordinary paid work.

Snowmelt Residential Steps - Communal Wash Shelter

A roofed shelter offers basins and drying lines for local households. Water is supplied through managed distribution rather than by the sacred bones. Work and conversation overlap here, with privacy and access depending on actual custom. Atsuko Ōhira is usually based here, working as neighborhood clothing mender.

Snowmelt Residential Steps - Roofward Landing

A landing above the main stair overlooks a patchwork of chimneys and roofs. Repair ladders are secured when not in use. It is a good meeting place for a resident, not a public route into every upper window.

Snowmelt Residential Steps - Snowmelt Landing Flat

A compact landing flat with a sleeping alcove, tiny hearth kitchen, work table and sheltered gear cupboard.

18. Cinderstone Schoolhouse

Initially known

A medium-sized, plain stone schoolhouse provides Drakenspire's ordinary education: reading, arithmetic, local history and practical foundations for daily life. Its modest classrooms also accommodate some adult lessons and community instruction. It is not a fifth magical academy or a rival to Glowhaven's specialist institutions. Serious magic study often takes residents abroad to Glowhaven. Visitors may arrange an educational demonstration, deliver supplies or inquire about public classes through the office rather than interrupting lessons.

People associated with this place include: Aya Tsukino - Cinderstone schoolteacher.

Cinderstone Schoolhouse - School Entrance

Boot racks and damp wool line a modest entrance beside the office door. Notices list lessons and community uses of the building. Visitors announce their business rather than walking straight into a class.

Cinderstone Schoolhouse - Main Classroom

Plain desks face a chalkboard with sums, reading exercises and maps of familiar routes. Daylight enters through high windows. The room supports ordinary teaching, with the actual class and age group determined by the scheduled activity. Aya Tsukino is usually based here, working as cinderstone schoolteacher.

Cinderstone Schoolhouse - Practical Room

Measuring tools, simple models and sturdy worktables support hands-on lessons. Supplies are counted and stored after use. A guest can offer a supervised demonstration without transforming the room into an advanced spell laboratory.

Cinderstone Schoolhouse - Reading and Records Room

Shared books stand beside cupboards of attendance and lesson records. Adult learners may use the public reading materials at suitable times. Personal records remain with the school, while local histories can provide a starting point for research.

19. Lower Hold Gate

Initially known

The main overland gate stands where the lower shelf meets the descending mountain road. Snowbreak walls protect a broad cart entrance, a pedestrian passage and a sheltered inspection yard. Guards and road workers watch weather, loads and reports from the passes. Unlike the magical Portal Room, this gate opens onto the physical mountain routes. Visitors can arrange an escort, learn of a closure or wait for a caravan, while returning residents bring in livestock and supplies.

People associated with this place include: Kensaku Honjō - Lower gate duty officer.

Lower Hold Gate - Cart Arch

A broad reinforced arch admits wagons and pack animals one group at a time when traffic is heavy. Guards keep the center clear while examining an unusual load. Snow chains and wheel damage are practical concerns here.

Lower Hold Gate - Pedestrian Passage

A smaller door opens into a sheltered footway with a view of the road. Travelers check straps and clothing before leaving. Posted warnings describe known conditions, with rumor and confirmed reports kept distinct.

Lower Hold Gate - Holding Yard

A walled yard accommodates waiting caravans, deliveries and animals. Water troughs and tie rails are maintained for actual users. A delay can create conversation or a small repair job without trapping the whole city.

Lower Hold Gate - Road Office

Route notes, patrol reports and supply schedules fill a cramped office near the gate. Staff can explain current advice and who maintains a road. They cannot promise that weather or territorial creatures will obey yesterday's report. Kensaku Honjō is usually based here, working as lower gate duty officer.

20. Iwatsugu Clanhold

Initially known

A substantial but practical clan house serves Iwatsugu households and dependents in the capital. The clan's long connections with stonework, quarrying and early settlement give it influence in repairs and public construction, though its members follow many trades. Petitioners discuss contracts, kinship obligations and support for local works in a public receiving wing. The clanhold is a household as well as a political address; visitors are welcomed according to their business, not granted free access to family rooms.

People associated with this place include: Tsubaki Iwatsugu - Acting household administrator of Clan Iwatsugu.

Iwatsugu Clanhold - Receiving Porch

Stone samples and old repair marks decorate a covered porch. Visitors wait near a bell and a table for delivery papers. Practical conversation often begins with which roof, road or wall needs attention.

Iwatsugu Clanhold - Common Hall

A broad hearth warms tables used for meals, negotiations and family gatherings. Work notices share wall space with memorial cloths. Business guests enter by invitation and may find an ordinary household meal rather than a political council.

Iwatsugu Clanhold - Works Office

Plans, measurements and agreed accounts occupy a small office. Clerks can locate the responsible contractor or explain a promised repair. A persuasive request still needs labor, materials and a decision before work is done. Tsubaki Iwatsugu is usually based here, working as acting household administrator of clan iwatsugu.

Iwatsugu Clanhold - Family Court

A quiet inner court separates the receiving wing from private rooms. Snow is swept into a corner beside stored gardening pots. Its domestic use should remain distinct from the clan's public offices.

21. Yukinose Clanhold

Initially known

Yukinose's capital house links rural households, provisioners and people who maintain routes through winter. Its influence rests partly on knowing how food, wool and freight actually reach the city. A busy receiving room handles letters, deliveries and requests from outlying settlements. The house is warm rather than lavish, with space set aside for visiting kin. Clan members are not all shepherds or carriers; shared obligations and history matter more than a single profession.

People associated with this place include: Masatsugu Yukinose - Chief of Clan Yukinose; Koharu Yukinose - Clan Yukinose route captain and provision escort.

Yukinose Clanhold - Delivery Porch

Bundles, letters and travelers arriving from smaller settlements pass through a sheltered porch. A board lists expected loads rather than guaranteed stock. Visitors can leave a message or inquire where a delivery belongs. Koharu Yukinose is usually based here, working as clan yukinose route captain and provision escort.

Yukinose Clanhold - Hospitality Hall

A large table and dependable hearth welcome invited travelers and family business. Stew and wet-cloak steam mingle in the warm air. Hospitality is personal and finite, not an unlimited supply of free lodging for strangers. Masatsugu Yukinose is usually based here, working as chief of clan yukinose.

Yukinose Clanhold - Provision Office

Route accounts and household requests are sorted beside maps of the approaches. Staff compare need with what can actually move in the weather. A useful report from the road may matter more than an impressive title.

Yukinose Clanhold - Guest Landing

Simple guest rooms open from a quiet upper landing. Stays are arranged through the household. A traveler resting here remains a guest, not automatically a clan member or political representative.

22. Arashimine Clanhold

Initially known

Arashimine's clan house stands near the routes between the forge district and upper defenses. Its historic ties to arms-making and military service lend weight to discussions of contracts, training and readiness. The building is solid and restrained, with a receiving hall and an enclosed equipment court. Clan pride can coexist with ordinary domestic life, artistic interests and dissent. Visitors may bring a contract, a service petition or a personal invitation; the house is not a public challenge arena.

People associated with this place include: Tomoe Arashimine - Chief of Clan Arashimine; Akitsu Arashimine - Clan Arashimine weapons designer and contract negotiator.

Arashimine Clanhold - Gate Court

A stout gate opens onto a cleared court with racks for deliveries. Visitors are directed to the receiving wing before unloading. Weapons stay sheathed during ordinary business unless there is a specific supervised reason to display them.

Arashimine Clanhold - Receiving Hall

Old campaign cloths and examples of careful metalwork line a warm hall. Conversations concern families and work as often as battles. Hospitality does not entitle a stranger to demand a duel or inspect private heirlooms.

Arashimine Clanhold - Contract Room

Tables hold specifications, delivery records and correspondence with workshops. Disagreement can turn on an exact requirement rather than someone's honor. Original papers remain with their custodians after consultation. Tomoe Arashimine is usually based here, working as chief of clan arashimine.

Arashimine Clanhold - Equipment Court

A sheltered rear court allows invited inspection and maintenance of equipment. It is used for practical checks, not public entertainment. Noise is kept within the working hours agreed with neighboring homes. Akitsu Arashimine is usually based here, working as clan arashimine weapons designer and contract negotiator.

23. The Hold's Judgment House

Initially known

A plain civic building handles complaints, evidence and hearings beneath the authority of Drakenspire's government. Residents bring damaged property claims, assault reports and contractual disputes here. Guards maintain a small secure holding space for immediate custody while matters are assessed; it is not Wraith Island Prison or a new realm. The public hall distinguishes testimony from rumor and permits ordinary disputes to be heard without turning every conflict into a clan feud.

People associated with this place include: Setsuna Takigawa - Judge of the Hold's Judgment House.

The Hold's Judgment House - Complaints Desk

A counter receives written and spoken reports, with benches for people waiting their turn. Clerks ask what happened, where and who can confirm it. They do not know a stranger's private history without being told.

The Hold's Judgment House - Hearing Room

A modest chamber provides places for the presiding official, witnesses and parties to a dispute. Statements can be challenged and documents examined. The room is suitable for a small civil matter as well as a serious accusation. Setsuna Takigawa is usually based here, working as judge of the hold's judgment house.

The Hold's Judgment House - Evidence Office

Locked cupboards and labeled receipts track property submitted for a case. Access is supervised. An object being examined remains under documented custody; narration should not silently remove or return it outside an actual transfer.

The Hold's Judgment House - Holding Passage

A guarded passage leads to a few temporary cells and a duty bench. It serves short-term local custody rather than an island prison sentence. A detainee's treatment and release depend on the actual case and authorities involved.

24. The Tempered Fang

Initially known

This respected specialist workshop builds and maintains weapons intended to carry learned spellwork. Its smiths discuss balance, grip, channel behavior and the wielder's actual methods before recommending a design. Racks display varied practical forms rather than one compulsory Drakenspire fighting style. A spellblade can commission a blade, arrange a refit or investigate why a trusted weapon behaves poorly. Fine craftsmanship can support a user's abilities; buying an expensive weapon does not teach spells or guarantee victory.

People associated with this place include: Benjirō Kanemori - Master spellblade smith and owner of The Tempered Fang.

The Tempered Fang - Consultation Counter

Balanced samples and unfinished grips let customers describe how they fight. The discussion covers reach, handling and casting practice before ornament. A quote may change with the material chosen, but the reason should be explained.

The Tempered Fang - Fitting Floor

A clear floor and plain practice targets allow supervised handling checks. Customers test the feel of appropriate samples without striking other visitors. A good fit depends on the person, not simply their height or species. Benjirō Kanemori is usually based here, working as master spellblade smith and owner of the tempered fang.

The Tempered Fang - Channel Bench

Fine tools and magnifying lenses surround partly finished spell-channel work. Access is controlled because accidental casting can damage a commission. Inspection can distinguish a damaged conductor from a caster's unfamiliar technique.

The Tempered Fang - Proofing Booth

A stone-lined booth permits limited testing with agreed precautions. Marks on the backing record actual tests rather than promises of unlimited power. Completed work is released through the counter after its terms are settled.

25. Rivet & Rime Armory

Initially known

A practical armory supplies armor, shields and protective fittings suited to cold travel and hard use. Its stock includes shapes that accommodate horns, tails and different bodies without making every garment an exotic commission. Travelers seek strap replacement, sensible layers and equipment they can actually move in. The armory serves guards, hunters and ordinary workers; expensive decoration is available by commission but does not dominate the shop. A fitting can be a useful conversation about the difference between looking prepared and being prepared.

People associated with this place include: Hibiki Takanashi - Armorer at Rivet & Rime.

Rivet & Rime Armory - Display Room

Shields, protective coats and plate fittings hang beside clear examples of repairs. Customers can compare condition and intended use. The room smells of leather dressing and cold metal rather than constant furnace smoke.

Rivet & Rime Armory - Fitting Alcove

Screens and a raised fitting platform provide privacy for measurements. Tail openings, joints and layered clothing are checked for movement. Staff treat bodies practically; a dragonkin customer is not a spectacle. Hibiki Takanashi is usually based here, working as armorer at rivet & rime.

Rivet & Rime Armory - Strap and Rivet Bench

Small hammers and punches sit beside sorted buckles and leather. Minor repairs may be assessed here while the customer waits. Work still needs agreement, materials and completion before the item is restored.

Rivet & Rime Armory - Delivery Cupboard

Labeled completed orders are kept behind the counter, separate from general stock. Collection requires the correct customer or authorized messenger. A similar-looking shield on the shelf is not necessarily the one ordered.

26. The Woolen Wyvern

Initially known

A cheerful tailor and winter outfitter sells wool layers, lined coats, gloves and repairs. Its wooden wyvern sign is a shop joke, not evidence that the animal is sacred like a dragon. Customers range from local households replacing worn cuffs to visitors discovering how little their city clothes help in mountain wind. Practical cuts allow horns and tails room without sacrificing warmth. Bright cloth, careful stitching and candid fitting advice make the shop a comfortable stop between harder errands.

People associated with this place include: Shino Kazamaki - Clothier and owner of The Woolen Wyvern.

The Woolen Wyvern - Front Shop

Bolts of wool and hanging coats fill a warm, colorful room. A small board lists ordinary repair services. Customers can browse without being pressured into a supposedly essential magical purchase. Shino Kazamaki is usually based here, working as clothier and owner of the woolen wyvern.

The Woolen Wyvern - Fitting Screens

Curtained spaces and mirrors allow private fittings. Hooks hold outer layers while sleeve and tail openings are checked. A comfortable garment should account for actual anatomy and movement rather than a generic human silhouette.

The Woolen Wyvern - Mending Table

Spools, patches and neatly sorted fasteners surround a broad table. Workers assess frayed seams and torn lining before promising a repair. An old coat may be worth keeping for fit or sentiment even when replacement is possible.

The Woolen Wyvern - Cloth Loft

A low loft stores seasonal fabric and unfinished orders away from wet boots. Access is by invitation. Delivery mistakes here involve actual labeled work, not a cache of free luxury outfits.

27. Coppercrest Exchange

Initially known

One of the lower city's conspicuously wealthy buildings, Coppercrest Exchange houses trading rooms, brokers' offices and a covered contract floor. Polished copper trim and tall glass windows contrast with the practical government buildings above. Merchants negotiate metal, magical raw materials and freight capacity here, often linking Drakenspire suppliers with Glowhaven workshops. Visitors can seek an appraisal referral, negotiate a consignment or find transport. The building is a commercial meeting place, not a bank that automatically grants accounts or credit.

People associated with this place include: Iori Yukinose - Clan Yukinose commercial envoy and junior festival patron; Saeha Kogetsu - Proprietor of Coppercrest Exchange.

Coppercrest Exchange - Trading Floor

Warm light catches polished rails around tables of samples and paperwork. Brokers introduce actual buyers and sellers rather than announce unlimited demand. A visitor can compare offers while remaining free to walk away. Saeha Kogetsu is usually based here, working as proprietor of coppercrest exchange.

Coppercrest Exchange - Sample Gallery

Sealed examples of metal, crystal and amber sit with declared provenance and specifications. Displaying a sample does not prove the entire consignment matches it. Buyers may arrange independent assessment before committing.

Coppercrest Exchange - Negotiation Rooms

Small private rooms allow parties to discuss price, delivery and liability. Walls reduce ordinary noise without promising perfect magical secrecy. Agreements remain the terms actually accepted, not whatever a bystander assumes was settled. Iori Yukinose is usually based here, working as clan yukinose commercial envoy and junior festival patron.

Coppercrest Exchange - Freight Ledger Office

Carriers and brokers compare available loads, routes and delivery windows. Weather and portal capacity can complicate a plan. A booking does not itself move cargo, issue a court key or grant access to restricted warehouses.

Coppercrest Exchange - Upper Reception

A tasteful sitting room offers a view across lower-city roofs toward the sacred crescent. Rich hosts sometimes use it to impress clients. The view and furnishings indicate wealth, not official authority over the Jarl.

28. Amberglass Assay House

Initially known

A professional assay house evaluates the composition, condition and declared origin of valuable raw materials. Mountain amber, mana crystals, unusual metal and legally obtained creature materials arrive in sealed trays. Its work supports trade and craft rather than serving as a grand magical research academy. Customers can request a defined examination and receive findings with appropriate limits. A certified sample can improve confidence in a deal, but it cannot guarantee every claim about a larger unseen shipment.

People associated with this place include: Takumi Hasebe - Assayer at Amberglass.

Amberglass Assay House - Intake Counter

Samples are received with their owner's account of origin and requested examination. Trays and receipts distinguish one customer's property from another's. The counter establishes custody before testing begins.

Amberglass Assay House - Examination Room

Good light, lenses and calibrated tools support careful inspection of material structure. Appropriate magical methods complement ordinary observation. A test addresses a question; it is not universal identification of every secret an object carries. Takumi Hasebe is usually based here, working as assayer at amberglass.

Amberglass Assay House - Sealed Sample Store

Controlled cupboards separate samples awaiting work from retained reference material. Labels record handling needs and permission for destructive tests. Valuable fragments remain under custody until properly released.

Amberglass Assay House - Findings Desk

Completed reports explain what was observed, what remains uncertain and how the sample compares with its claims. Buyers and sellers may discuss a discrepancy here. A report is evidence, not a self-enforcing verdict.

29. Crystalcutters' Court

Initially known

A shared court of small workshops cuts, grades and prepares mana-bearing crystals for further craft. Covered benches face a cleared yard where workers can handle deliveries without crowding delicate work. The trade links mountain extraction with Glowhaven enchantment and local weapon making. Visitors can arrange a cut, seek advice on damaged material or watch permitted demonstrations. The court's expertise is specialized; a beautifully prepared crystal still needs an actual purpose, compatible construction and skilled use.

People associated with this place include: Hotaru Kise - Crystal cutter and bench artisan.

Crystalcutters' Court - Sorting Yard

Covered trays separate rough material by declared origin and visible condition. Workers keep heavy loads away from precision benches. A mislabeled parcel can delay several commissions without threatening the city's entire supply.

Crystalcutters' Court - Cutting Gallery

Protected windows allow visitors to observe cutting and polishing at safe distance. Fine grit and bright task lights mark patient work. Entering the working side requires a specific invitation and attention to hazards. Hotaru Kise is usually based here, working as crystal cutter and bench artisan.

Crystalcutters' Court - Design Bench

Templates and sample mounts help clients discuss a crystal's intended fit. Shape, flaws and available material constrain the result. A design consultation does not grant the enchantment that another specialist may later apply.

Crystalcutters' Court - Offcut Store

Small fragments are kept in labeled containers for reuse or sale. Staff can quote an appropriate batch for a real task. The store is not a limitless source of free magical ammunition.

30. Resin & Root Apothecary

Initially known

This compact apothecary sells prepared remedies and supplies practitioners with correctly handled ingredients. Dried mountain plants, resins and preserved creature materials occupy separate cupboards behind a plain counter. Customers come for ordinary care, preparation advice or a specific commission, not only rare magical cures. The proprietor's role is practical service; a reagent's unusual origin does not make it safe to swallow. The shop can connect field collection with responsible assessment and actual potion work.

People associated with this place include: Yoriko Tsumura - Apothecary and healer of Resin & Root.

Resin & Root Apothecary - Remedy Counter

Wrapped preparations and labeled supplies sit behind a clean counter. Questions concern the actual complaint and intended use. A sale or treatment requires an agreed item or service, with effects limited to its real definition.

Resin & Root Apothecary - Ingredient Cabinets

Dry roots, resins and sealed specimens are separated by handling requirements. Visitors can discuss an ingredient without opening every jar. Origin and condition matter, especially when a mountain collector offers something unfamiliar.

Resin & Root Apothecary - Preparation Room

A ventilated workroom contains scales, mortars and clean vessels. Staff prepare actual orders and reject contaminated material. Observation does not instantly teach a complex formula or provide the observer with its finished product.

Resin & Root Apothecary - Consultation Nook

A screened seat allows a quieter conversation about care or a difficult commission. Privacy is ordinary professional discretion, not an impenetrable magical barrier. Serious conditions may require an appropriate healer rather than a convenient bottle. Yoriko Tsumura is usually based here, working as apothecary and healer of resin & root.

31. Snowchain Freight Yard

Initially known

A walled freight yard gathers loads for the portalward quarter, local workshops and overland caravans. Roofed bays, chain hoists and broad lanes keep cargo moving without spilling into the market. Workers sort imports, raw materials and completed equipment while carriers plan around weather and access. Visitors can arrange a delivery, find legitimate day work or investigate a delayed consignment. Goods do not become unowned because they are outdoors, and a freight job grants only the tools and access actually agreed.

People associated with this place include: Tsugumi Arata - Snowchain freight dispatcher.

Snowchain Freight Yard - Dispatch Shelter

A roofed desk coordinates loads, carriers and collection times. Chalkboards show assignments rather than omniscient tracking. A missing delivery requires checking its last confirmed handoff, not guessing the responsible thief. Tsugumi Arata is usually based here, working as snowchain freight dispatcher.

Snowchain Freight Yard - Covered Bays

Numbered bays hold sealed freight above the snow. Workers compare labels before moving anything. Buyers, owners and carriers may have different rights to inspect or release the same load.

Snowchain Freight Yard - Hoist Lane

Heavy cranes and chain hoists move bulky loads along a clear lane. Bells and shouted warnings keep bystanders out from under suspended cargo. Helping requires suitable skill and supervision rather than a casual strength display.

Snowchain Freight Yard - Carriers' Room

A warm room offers benches, route notices and space to repair straps. Carriers exchange practical news while waiting for assignments. Some want conversation; others simply want their meal and a dry pair of gloves.

32. The Copper Ram

Initially known

A busy lower-city tavern serves substantial meals, drink and an easy place to spend an evening. A copper ram above the door is polished by weather and smoke. Workers, merchants and off-duty guards mix without becoming one friendly chorus. Storytelling, complaints and occasional music give the room life; the host expects weapons to stay out of arguments. Visitors can meet people or enjoy their food without being recruited into a quest just for entering.

People associated with this place include: Iroha Sagiri - Host and music arranger at The Copper Ram.

The Copper Ram - Taproom

Dark beams and warm lamps shelter close-set tables and a long serving counter. Conversation rises and falls with the crowd. A patron's free seat is an opportunity to ask, not automatic permission to join their company. Iroha Sagiri is usually based here, working as host and music arranger at the copper ram.

The Copper Ram - Hearth Tables

Larger tables near the fire suit meals and groups of friends. The smell of meat and onions clings to wool sleeves. People here may care more about a delayed wage or a bad joke than national politics.

The Copper Ram - Musicians' Corner

A small cleared corner accommodates a singer or a few musicians when someone is performing. At other times it holds ordinary tables. Music adds atmosphere without making every visit a festival.

The Copper Ram - Back Yard

A sheltered yard receives deliveries and gives patrons a place for cold air. Staff keep the service route clear. Arguments taken outside do not become lawful duels simply by leaving the taproom.

33. Hearthpot Stew House

Initially known

An inexpensive eating house near the market serves slow-cooked meat, broth, bread and seasonal additions. Its menu follows available supplies, with local cheese and imported ingredients appearing when trade permits. Workers value a warm bowl without ceremony; travelers appreciate being able to eat without bargaining over an adventure. The room is modest, crowded at mealtimes and quieter between them. Takeaway portions and agreed deliveries can connect it to ordinary local work.

People associated with this place include: Daisuke Toyama - Cook and proprietor of Hearthpot Stew House.

Hearthpot Stew House - Serving Counter

Steam clouds the glass near a row of covered pots. Customers choose from the day's actual offerings and settle the price. The counter moves quickly when people know their order and slowly when a large group arrives together. Daisuke Toyama is usually based here, working as cook and proprietor of hearthpot stew house.

Hearthpot Stew House - Shared Tables

Plain benches fit workers, families and lone diners into a warm room. Space for tails is negotiated with the same practical courtesy as space for bags. Conversation is possible, but a quiet customer can simply eat.

Hearthpot Stew House - Kitchen Door

The kitchen beyond a half-door contains busy cooks and hot equipment. Deliveries and work inquiries are handled without letting visitors crowd the preparation area. Smells and overheard orders convey activity without exposing private business.

Hearthpot Stew House - Pickup Window

A small window serves wrapped meals and agreed deliveries to people who cannot linger. Labels and collection times prevent confusion. Receiving someone else's order by mistake does not transfer its ownership.

34. Stonewake Onsen

Initially known

Drakenspire's one public onsen occupies a sheltered lower ledge where geothermal water is brought up and carefully managed. Stone pools, washing rooms and a warm rest hall provide relief from cold travel and physical work. Bathing arrangements respect privacy, hygiene and actual patron preferences; a shared bath is not an automatic romantic encounter. The springs owe their warmth to the mountain's geology, not the sacred skeleton. Fees, private bookings and treatments are ordinary services rather than universal healing magic.

People associated with this place include: Toki Toyama - Manager of Stonewake Onsen.

Stonewake Onsen - Reception and Shoe Racks

A modest reception handles fees, towels and current bathing arrangements. Shoes and travel gear remain outside wet areas. Staff explain available private or shared use without assuming every visitor wants the same experience. Toki Toyama is usually based here, working as manager of stonewake onsen.

Stonewake Onsen - Changing and Washing Rooms

Screened changing spaces lead to washing stations before the pools. Secure storage and clear etiquette protect privacy. Ordinary anatomy, including horns and tails, is accommodated without spectacle or compulsory nudity in narration.

Stonewake Onsen - Sheltered Stone Pool

A broad pool sits beneath high eaves with an open view of snow beyond a privacy wall. Steam softens the cold air. Its warmth encourages unhurried conversation or silence, with personal boundaries still applying.

Stonewake Onsen - Private Bath Rooms

Bookable small rooms provide separate bathing for those who prefer it. Availability and access follow actual arrangements. A reservation covers the agreed room and time, not unrestricted access to other guests.

Stonewake Onsen - Rest Hall

Dry seating, drinking water and simple refreshments let patrons cool down before dressing for the weather. Quiet conversations linger here. Staff keep the room comfortable without turning it into a second tavern or medical ward.

35. Snowbell Playhouse

Initially known

A modest timber-and-stone playhouse hosts music, storytelling, comic performances and occasional community meetings. Its crowded cloak racks and practical benches matter more than grand ornament. Local stories may celebrate dragons or ancestors, but the repertoire also includes household farce, traveling acts and bad romances. Visitors can buy admission, ask about work or see a performance already scheduled. Artists and audiences can disagree about taste without threatening the national faith.

People associated with this place include: Suzune Hanekawa - Leading actress at Snowbell Playhouse.

Snowbell Playhouse - Box Office

A small counter handles seats and posted performance times. Cloak racks fill quickly before a show. Questions about work or a booking can be directed here without interrupting a rehearsal.

Snowbell Playhouse - Audience Hall

Plain benches face a shallow stage beneath dark roof beams. Good acoustics make a quiet line carry. The room may hold an attentive crowd, a sparse matinee or no audience at all according to the actual event.

Snowbell Playhouse - Stage and Wings

Painted flats, ropes and stored props crowd the edges of a practical stage. Performers need room to work. Entry requires a reason and permission, and borrowed props remain the company's property.

Snowbell Playhouse - Rehearsal Loft

An upper room holds music stands, spare costumes and marked scripts. Rehearsal can be repetitive and unglamorous. A visitor may learn about local storytelling through conversation without instantly becoming part of the company. Suzune Hanekawa is usually based here, working as leading actress at snowbell playhouse.

36. The Cinder Pit

Initially known

A compact enclosed fighting venue gives Drakenspire a lawful place for public bouts. It is much smaller than Glowhaven's coliseum: a sunken fighting floor, close spectator tiers and practical rooms for competitors. Match officials establish the rules, permitted equipment and stopping conditions for the event. Spectators come for skill, rivalry and entertainment, while participants can test themselves through an actual booking. The existence of the pit does not make street challenges lawful or guarantee a safe mismatch.

People associated with this place include: Gentarō Bando - Match promoter and proprietor of The Cinder Pit; Tamaki Naruse - Cinder Pit wrestler and contracted duelist.

The Cinder Pit - Booking Desk

Officials register actual bouts, explain rules and assess whether proposed opponents belong in the same event. A boast is not a signed match. Equipment and medical concerns can delay a booking for practical reasons. Gentarō Bando is usually based here, working as match promoter and proprietor of the cinder pit.

The Cinder Pit - Spectator Tiers

Close stone tiers give the audience a clear view of the compact floor. Food sellers and ushers keep the aisles usable. The crowd can favor a fighter without becoming one unanimous voice.

The Cinder Pit - Fighting Floor

A sunken, maintained surface sits inside protective barriers appropriate to the agreed bout. Entry and commencement are explicit. A stopped match remains stopped; applause does not authorize continued violence.

The Cinder Pit - Competitors' Rooms

Simple rooms hold benches, water and space to check gear before and after a bout. Competitors retain privacy and ownership of equipment. A rivalry can become a conversation here rather than another compulsory fight. Tamaki Naruse is usually based here, working as cinder pit wrestler and contracted duelist.

The Cinder Pit - Treatment Alcove

A staffed alcove supports assessment and immediate care within available means. Officials can suspend a bout for injury. Healing is not an excuse to ignore damage or grant unlimited recovery beyond actual treatment.

37. Deepwell Waterworks

Initially known

A low utilitarian complex manages water drawn from deep mountain aquifers and distributed through protected channels and storage. Workers maintain pumps, settling chambers and freeze protection while monitoring the supply to households and public services. The city also uses geothermal sources where appropriate, including Stonewake Onsen, but drinking water and bathing water are managed according to their actual quality. Visitors may deliver parts, report a leak or undertake supervised repair work. The skeleton is not the source of the water system's power or heat.

People associated with this place include: Shigemori Abe - Deepwell senior maintenance engineer.

Deepwell Waterworks - Maintenance Office

Route diagrams, fault reports and work orders fill a warm office. Residents can report a problem at a specific address. Staff distinguish the immediate complaint from the work needed deeper in the system.

Deepwell Waterworks - Pump Chamber

Heavy machinery and protected fittings draw and move water from the rock below. Noise and slippery surfaces limit casual access. Work requires appropriate preparation and permission, especially near moving parts. Shigemori Abe is usually based here, working as deepwell senior maintenance engineer.

Deepwell Waterworks - Settling Gallery

Covered channels and tanks permit inspection of sediment and flow. Workers take actual samples rather than judge safety from appearance alone. The gallery is a workplace, not a public bathing pool.

Deepwell Waterworks - Distribution Vault

Labeled controls and branch lines feed different parts of the lower city. An adjustment can affect several customers, so workers record changes. Closing a valve to solve one problem may require warning the people downstream.

38. Hoofstep Pens

Initially known

Sheltered livestock pens near the lower approach receive goats, sheep and working animals moving between pasture, market and households. Feed stores, inspection space and practical handling lanes keep the place busy. Herding is a major part of Drakenspire's food and wool economy without covering every mountain in farmland. Visitors can arrange transport, purchase through actual owners or help with a defined task. The animals are ordinary living stock, not automatic familiars or a combat encounter waiting to happen.

People associated with this place include: Uta Fumizawa - Livestock handler and seasonal wool grader.

Hoofstep Pens - Receiving Lane

Low rails guide arriving animals into the correct enclosure. Handlers check the owner's information and the animals' condition. Noise and unfamiliar people can complicate an otherwise ordinary delivery.

Hoofstep Pens - Sheltered Pens

Deep eaves and windbreak walls protect small groups from severe weather. Water, bedding and space need regular attention. Visitors remain outside the rails unless the responsible handler agrees to their help.

Hoofstep Pens - Feed Store

Dry storage keeps hay and supplementary feed away from damp and pests. Deliveries are counted before stacking. A shortage creates a practical supply problem with affected owners, not a reason to conjure limitless provisions.

Hoofstep Pens - Handling Yard

A small yard supports loading, basic inspection and careful movement of stock. People stand where handlers direct them. A successful task can be quiet and uneventful rather than a dramatic test of dominance. Uta Fumizawa is usually based here, working as livestock handler and seasonal wool grader.

39. Woolridge Pastures

Initially known

Protected grazing folds and winter shelters occupy usable lower slopes beneath the capital. Goats and sheep move according to the season and conditions; deep snow makes stored feed essential. Stone walls and low buildings break the wind without erasing the mountain's difficulty. Visitors may help with an agreed delivery, inspect damage or learn about local husbandry. The pastures give the city's meat, dairy and wool a visible source, while imports still provide much of what the terrain cannot reliably grow.

Woolridge Pastures - Lower Fold

Stone walls enclose a manageable patch of grazing and holding ground. Gates are kept latched for practical reasons. Visitors can speak with workers without scattering the stock across the slope.

Woolridge Pastures - Winter Shelter

Low roofed sheds protect animals during poor weather. Bedding and stored feed require regular work. Warmth here comes from shelter, labor and supplies rather than a permanent magical summer.

Woolridge Pastures - Shearing Shed

A clean practical shed stores shearing tools and sorted wool. Its busiest periods follow actual seasonal work. At other times it serves for maintenance and preparation, not a constant public demonstration.

Woolridge Pastures - Herders' Track

A narrow track links the folds and lower settlements, with sightlines across snow and rock. Fresh tracks can reveal ordinary movement or a problem worth reporting. The route is easier than the high ranges but still exposed to weather.

40. Winter Stores

Initially known

A practical depot holds public and contracted reserves of fuel, preserved food and winter equipment. Thick walls and carefully ventilated rooms protect supplies, while loading bays keep deliveries out of the residential stairs. The depot supports ordinary resilience rather than implying the city is permanently starving. Workers track what belongs to the hold, what belongs to merchants and what is already promised. Visitors may carry an authorized delivery, report damaged stock or seek the office responsible for an actual distribution.

People associated with this place include: Michiru Aonuma - Winter Stores distribution keeper.

Winter Stores - Receiving Bay

Loads are inspected and counted under a wide roof before entering storage. Damp packaging and damaged seals are noted. A delivery is complete only after the responsible parties actually accept it.

Winter Stores - Food Vault

Cool dry chambers hold preserved provisions in labeled lots. Staff rotate supplies and check their condition. Visitors cannot infer the city's total reserves from one visible row of barrels.

Winter Stores - Fuel Shed

Covered stacks of fuel remain separate from food and open flames. Workers manage ventilation and safe handling. A small mistake here can be hazardous without requiring a magical saboteur.

Winter Stores - Distribution Office

Clerks compare requests, commitments and available stock. People can ask about a delayed allocation and present evidence. The office may explain a limit without being indifferent to the household affected. Michiru Aonuma is usually based here, working as winter stores distribution keeper.

41. Whitepass Watchpost

Initially known

A small fortified road post watches a vulnerable stretch of the lower mountain approach. Its garrison maintains warning signals, receives road reports and provides limited emergency shelter. It is neither a sprawling castle nor a second capital. Caravans stop to compare conditions and confirm whether a route is open. Work can include carrying a message, repairing a signal or checking an overdue traveler, with urgency determined by actual evidence rather than the assumption that every delay means an attack.

People associated with this place include: Yūsuke Ebina - Whitepass watch sergeant.

Whitepass Watchpost - Road Barrier

A movable barrier slows approaching traffic beside a sheltered guard position. It may be open during normal travel and closed for an actual hazard. Guards can explain the reason rather than demand a duel or arbitrary toll.

Whitepass Watchpost - Signal Platform

A raised platform holds maintained signal equipment with views toward the capital and nearby road. Weather limits visibility. A signal carries its established meaning; it does not transmit a complete conversation by default. Yūsuke Ebina is usually based here, working as whitepass watch sergeant.

Whitepass Watchpost - Shelter Room

A cramped warm room offers immediate refuge for stranded people. Space and supplies are finite. Sharing it can create ordinary cooperation between travelers without automatically forming a permanent party.

Whitepass Watchpost - Patrol Yard

Boot racks, spare poles and repair benches surround a small yard. Patrols prepare here and record what they actually observed. A missing patrol report remains uncertainty until someone checks the route.

42. Goatstep Hamlet

Initially known

A small inhabited hamlet occupies a sheltered fold below the city, with low stone houses, animal sheds and a shared meeting yard. Herding, wool work, repairs and trade keep it connected to Drakenspire without turning it into a miniature capital. The city can be seen from some paths, yet a bad storm can make a short delivery difficult. Visitors come for provisions, rural work or a quieter overnight arrangement. Residents have their own concerns and are not merely guides waiting for an adventurer.

People associated with this place include: Haruto Aonuma - Goatstep herder and hamlet representative.

Goatstep Hamlet - Meeting Yard

A sheltered open space joins the main houses and serves deliveries, conversation and small gatherings. A notice board carries practical requests. People recognize regular visitors, while newcomers can ask whose permission a job requires. Haruto Aonuma is usually based here, working as goatstep herder and hamlet representative.

Goatstep Hamlet - Wool Shed

Sorted fleeces and tools occupy a shared work shed. Workers discuss quality, orders and the weather while their hands stay busy. An interested visitor can learn something without receiving a full professional skill instantly.

Goatstep Hamlet - Guest Hearth

One household or host may offer a paid or invited place to sit, eat or sleep when available. The arrangement is made with the people present. A marked hearth is not an unlimited public lodging resource.

Goatstep Hamlet - Pasture Path

A stone-walled track leads toward grazing folds and the capital's supply routes. It carries animals, workers and small loads. Tracks and damaged fences can provide concrete clues to a local problem.

43. Pinefold Hollow

Initially known

A limited belt of hardy pines gathers in a sheltered depression where the mountain permits soil and somewhat gentler conditions. Snow hangs on branches above narrow animal paths and occasional permitted gathering sites. The hollow offers botanical observation, tracking and small-scale resource work close enough to inhabited routes to suit prepared beginners. It is not a vast forest surrounding the whole city. Its quiet can be uneventful, with birds, creaking branches and distant wind providing interest without a compulsory encounter. The Animal Run passes feeding and resting cover used by mountain predators. The sheltered collection margin gives observers a way to study the signs before committing.

Pinefold Hollow - Tree Line

Scattered pines thicken where a rock fold blocks the worst wind. Snow changes texture beneath the first branches. Tracks entering the hollow can be followed with care, though overlapping prints may be difficult to interpret.

Pinefold Hollow - Resin Stand

Older trees show carefully tended collection points where gathering has been permitted. Fresh cuts and weather damage are distinguishable with examination. Taking material requires an actual right or agreement, not merely knowing it is useful.

Pinefold Hollow - Animal Run

A low path winds between trunks and rocks, marked by occasional fur or disturbed snow. Observation can reveal habits without forcing contact. A traveler who follows it is entering an animal's route rather than a maintained footpath. The Animal Run passes feeding and resting cover used by mountain predators. The sheltered collection margin gives observers a way to study the signs before committing.

Pinefold Hollow - Sheltered Clearing

A small clearing offers space for a rest or careful field notes. Broken branches and soot can reveal earlier use. It is suitable for a temporary halt with appropriate precautions, not a guaranteed safe campsite in all weather.

44. Glassmere Basin

Initially known

A high basin holds a lake that freezes extensively in winter, with dark rock and snow framing its pale surface. The margins provide water observations, animal tracks and a striking place to understand local weather. Ice conditions vary; a smooth white surface is not proof that it will bear weight. Travelers may survey from firm shore, investigate a reported sound or watch wildlife at a distance. The basin is a natural landmark rather than an automatic entrance to an underwater temple. Thin ice at the margin and narrow inlet are the usual danger. Concentrated cold mana sometimes gathers into an Ice Elemental beneath a blue-lit fissure, where water trembles against the surrounding ice.

Glassmere Basin - Shore Stones

Broad rocks offer a firm place to stop above the frozen margin. Wind has stripped some surfaces clear and buried others. From here a traveler can observe the lake without immediately stepping onto it.

Glassmere Basin - Ice Margin

Layers of frozen water and drifted snow meet the shore in an irregular band. Cracks and trapped bubbles reveal differing conditions. Testing a small patch does not establish the safety of the entire lake. Thin ice at the margin and narrow inlet are the usual danger. Concentrated cold mana sometimes gathers into an Ice Elemental beneath a blue-lit fissure, where water trembles against the surrounding ice.

Glassmere Basin - Inlet Gully

A narrow gully carries water into the basin beneath patches of ice. Exposed movement makes the footing unreliable. The place offers useful hydrological observations for a prepared visitor who respects the unstable edge.

Glassmere Basin - Lee Overlook

A low ridge shelters a viewpoint across the basin and surrounding peaks. Animal movement can sometimes be watched from here. The stillness is valuable in its own right, with no requirement for an apparition or attack.

45. Redvein Mine

Initially known

Redvein is a working mine supplying metal-bearing ore to the city. Reinforced entrances, haul lanes and a surface office distinguish it from abandoned workings nearby. Crews follow practical safety routines and restrict visitors around active extraction. A traveler may deliver equipment, undertake a supervised inspection or assist with a specific problem. The mine matters economically, but Drakenspire's entire life does not revolve around it; crafts, trade, husbandry and households remain equally real parts of the nation.

People associated with this place include: Isamu Murakoshi - Redvein Mine crew foreman.

Redvein Mine - Surface Office

Shift records, delivery slips and safety notices occupy a stout building beside the entrance. Visitors state their business before entering the workings. Staff can identify the responsible crew without knowing every condition underground in real time. Isamu Murakoshi is usually based here, working as redvein mine crew foreman.

Redvein Mine - Haul Tunnel

Reinforced rails and haul lanes carry ore toward daylight. Passing places keep people clear of loaded movement. Noise and dust make communication harder, and a visitor must follow the crew's safety instructions.

Redvein Mine - Active Face

Workers extract a promising seam under maintained support. Access depends on current operations and conditions. Cracks, unusual water or a changed sound can require stopping work before the cause is known.

Redvein Mine - Ore Yard

Sorted loads wait under cover for weighing and shipment. Samples and entire consignments remain distinct. A buyer can arrange assessment without claiming everything visible in the yard.

46. Lanternamber Caverns

Initially known

Amber-bearing layers exposed in mountain caverns provide valuable raw material for careful extraction and study. Small lamps catch honey-colored seams in dark stone, while moisture and fractures complicate access. The entrance workings are managed; deeper routes are less reliable and require preparation. The amber's mana-bearing properties make it sought after, but its value depends on condition and usable material. Visitors can seek collection permission, survey a deposit or investigate a damaged shipment's source.

People associated with this place include: Madara Senzaki - Amber surveyor and contract field researcher.

Lanternamber Caverns - Keeper's Landing

A small sheltered station records entries, permitted tasks and returns. Lamps and route notes are checked before a party proceeds. Permission for one gallery does not automatically cover every deeper passage. Madara Senzaki is usually based here, working as amber surveyor and contract field researcher.

Lanternamber Caverns - Amber Seam

Warm-colored inclusions break the dark rock where a managed seam is exposed. Light makes them look more abundant than usable extraction may prove. Examination and proper tools are needed before a piece can be safely removed.

Lanternamber Caverns - Drip Gallery

Water falls through a narrow gallery onto slick stone. Mineral films and changing flow provide clues to conditions above. The passage is passable only with attention to footing and the actual weather's effects.

Lanternamber Caverns - Braced Work Niche

Timber and metal supports protect a small extraction niche. Tool marks and labeled sections show earlier work. A failing brace creates a repair problem before it becomes permission to blast the wall open.

47. The Abandoned Chainworks

Initially known

An obsolete haul complex clings to a steep mountain face, its rusting chains and broken platforms once linking upper workings to the road. The system was abandoned when safer routes and changing yields made its upkeep impractical. Snow now hides gaps in decks and the mouths of old shafts. It offers industrial history, careful salvage assessment and difficult exploration. The ruins are dangerous through age and terrain even if no creature happens to occupy them. Lower machinery bays provide spider cover, while one surviving load-frame may react if its live operating marks are disturbed. Rusted platforms remain dangerous even when no creature is active.

The Abandoned Chainworks - Rust Gate

A sagging entrance fence and faded notices mark the edge of the old works. Fresh footprints are conspicuous when snow has recently fallen. The gate is a warning boundary, not evidence that everything beyond it is ownerless.

The Abandoned Chainworks - Lift Platform

A broad platform projects over a shaft beneath heavy, corroded chains. Missing boards and uneven loading make it unreliable. It should not move safely simply because a traveler finds an old control lever.

The Abandoned Chainworks - Winch House

Frozen machinery fills a roof-damaged shelter. Manuals, wear and remaining parts can explain how the system worked. A competent examination may identify salvage or a limited repair without magically replacing missing components.

The Abandoned Chainworks - Lower Shaft Mouth

An old tunnel opens beneath the lift structure, partly obscured by fallen debris. Air movement and water sound hint at depth. Entering requires a real assessment of support, light and a way back. Lower machinery bays provide spider cover, while one surviving load-frame may react if its live operating marks are disturbed. Rusted platforms remain dangerous even when no creature is active.

48. Old Hearthfall

Initially known

An abandoned mining settlement occupies a fold beyond the maintained approaches. Roofless homes, a collapsed store and old drainage cuts show a community that dwindled as work moved elsewhere. Families left over time rather than vanishing in a single mysterious massacre. Descendants may still care about houses, records or memorials here. Visitors can examine the history of extraction, assess lawful salvage or trace how an ordinary settlement failed to remain viable in a difficult landscape. The empty house rows can shelter a predator or a small web pocket. Collapsed stores are unstable, with old beams resting unevenly beneath the remaining roof.

Old Hearthfall - Silent Street

Low walls and buried thresholds outline the former main street. Wind moves through missing roofs while surviving shutters knock against stone. Footprints can belong to occasional visitors or animals rather than a permanent hidden population.

Old Hearthfall - Collapsed Store

A broken roof covers the old supply shop. Shelving and labels hint at what residents once needed. Any surviving object must be assessed for condition and ownership before it becomes useful salvage.

Old Hearthfall - House Rows

Small homes stand in different stages of collapse. Domestic details make the settlement feel lived in and left behind. Entering one requires attention to structure, not an assumption that every floor is safe under the snow. The empty house rows can shelter a predator or a small web pocket. Collapsed stores are unstable, with old beams resting unevenly beneath the remaining roof.

Old Hearthfall - Drainage Cut

A stone channel once carried runoff away from the houses and workings. Ice now blocks sections of it. Following its condition can help explain damage without requiring an invented curse beneath the town.

49. Frostback Mountain

Initially known

A neighboring mountain rises beyond the city's protective shelves, its broad snowfields broken by dark ridges and steep faces. Frostback provides serious climbing, high-altitude fieldwork and access to more remote terrain. It is visible from Drakenspire but not a casual extension of the market streets. Weather, fatigue and route choice can matter as much as any creature. Preparation and retreat are sensible parts of an expedition; reaching a viewpoint does not obligate the party to attempt the summit. The snow saddle and scree traverse are dangerous crossings in bad conditions. Beyond them, actual territorial mountain wildlife can obstruct a route; the marked base is a place to prepare rather than an automatic fight.

Frostback Mountain - Base Cairns

Old route cairns stand above the last relatively sheltered approach. Travelers check supplies and compare conditions before climbing. A cairn indicates a known route, not a promise that today's weather permits it.

Frostback Mountain - Scree Traverse

A narrow traverse crosses loose stone exposed between snowfields. Movement can dislodge debris onto people below. Careful spacing and actual climbing ability matter more than a dramatic declaration of confidence.

Frostback Mountain - Snow Saddle

A broad saddle offers a view between peaks but receives heavy wind. Drifts can conceal changes in the underlying surface. It is a natural place to reassess the journey before committing to a harder ascent. The snow saddle and scree traverse are dangerous crossings in bad conditions. Beyond them, actual territorial mountain wildlife can obstruct a route; the marked base is a place to prepare rather than an automatic fight.

Frostback Mountain - Upper Spur

A rocky spur rises above the saddle toward more exposed ground. The view is exceptional in clear weather. Reaching it is a substantial outing across exposed mountain ground.

50. The Buried Switchback

Initially known

An old road climbs a slope where avalanches and drifting snow repeatedly obscure the bends. Some sections remain useful when conditions permit; others demand assessment or a different route. Broken markers and half-buried retaining walls show why local reports matter. Travelers might inspect damage, seek an overdue load or study snow conditions as part of a defined expedition. Terrain, accumulated snow and timing determine the avalanche risk. The buried bend crosses recent slide debris. Snow movement and unstable footing are the threat; the rock refuge is a genuine place to assess a safer method.

The Buried Switchback - Warning Turn

A sheltered bend holds current warnings when road workers have reached it. Older notices may remain beneath fresh marks. Travelers should distinguish the latest report from a faded account of another season.

The Buried Switchback - Buried Bend

Only the tops of roadside markers emerge from a wide drift. The road's true edge is difficult to judge. Probing, route knowledge and cautious movement can matter more than simply walking toward the next visible pole. The buried bend crosses recent slide debris. Snow movement and unstable footing are the threat; the rock refuge is a genuine place to assess a safer method.

The Buried Switchback - Slide Fan

Broken branches, packed debris and disturbed snow spread below an avalanche chute. The surface can conceal cavities and unstable material. Tracks or cargo fragments provide evidence of an actual incident if one has occurred.

The Buried Switchback - Rock Refuge

A shallow recess behind a rock shoulder offers limited shelter away from the main slide path. It is a place to regroup or wait for better information. It cannot protect an unlimited group from every scale of collapse.

51. Skreek Crags

Initially known

Steep crags beyond the safer routes provide perches and nesting sites for wyverns. These smaller, two-legged winged predators shriek over their territories and are regarded as troublesome pests rather than sacred dragons. Residents usually avoid their nesting ground instead of routinely organizing extermination. Observation, a necessary retrieval or a specific hunt can bring a prepared party here. Scored ledges, droppings and circling silhouettes warn of occupation well before close contact. Occupied nesting ledges are defended by their resident wyverns. Circling calls and scratched stone announce the boundary. The lookout permits observation and the scree route gives a real withdrawal option.

Skreek Crags - Scored Approach

Claw marks and scattered remains appear along the rocky approach. The smell and overhead movement can reveal proximity to active perches. Turning away is a reasonable response when the route is unnecessary.

Skreek Crags - Lookout Crack

A narrow rock cleft offers partial concealment for observation. It gives a limited view rather than perfect safety. Noise, scent and changing wind can still draw attention from creatures above.

Skreek Crags - Nesting Ledges

Broad shelves hold tangled nesting material where the cliff catches sunlight. Reaching them requires an exposed approach. Disturbing an occupied nest has predictable territorial consequences without granting the animals new magical powers. Occupied nesting ledges are defended by their resident wyverns. Circling calls and scratched stone announce the boundary. The lookout permits observation and the scree route gives a real withdrawal option.

Skreek Crags - Scree Escape

A steep scree line leads away from the principal perches toward lower rock. Retreat requires care because loose stone moves underfoot. It offers another route, not a guaranteed escape from every pursuit.

52. Giant's Hollow

Initially known

A remote hollow shows signs of use by mountain giants: enormous footprints, moved boulders and shelters sized for bodies far larger than local people. Its inhabitants and occupancy must be established through actual observation, not assumed from the name alone. The place is a serious expedition destination for tracking, study or a specific threat. Giants are not all mindless raiders, but entering an occupied camp without understanding its occupants is dangerous. The city remains distant enough that their presence does not imply a daily siege. Mountain giants use the moved-stone yard, carrying supplies beneath the overhang. Whether they warn, bargain or attack depends on the particular occupants. The high shelf affords a view of their camp without crossing the yard.

Giant's Hollow - Heavy Tracks

Deep impressions cross a sheltered approach where snow preserves their size. Their age and direction require interpretation. One set of prints does not establish the number, temper or present location of the inhabitants.

Giant's Hollow - Moved-Stone Yard

Large stones have been arranged in ways unlike natural scree. The space may serve work, shelter or storage depending on current use. A visitor can observe from its edge before deciding whether to approach farther. Mountain giants use the moved-stone yard, carrying supplies beneath the overhang. Whether they warn, bargain or attack depends on the particular occupants. The high shelf affords a view of their camp without crossing the yard.

Giant's Hollow - Overhang Shelter

A broad overhang shows wear and signs of occupation on a giant scale. Objects here belong to their actual users. An apparently empty shelter may still be someone's home rather than a treasure room.

Giant's Hollow - High Observation Shelf

A difficult side route reaches a shelf overlooking part of the hollow. It supports cautious study with a way to withdraw. Visibility remains partial, and a watcher should not gain omniscient knowledge of concealed occupants.

53. The White Silence

Initially unknown

Far from routine routes, a secluded snow basin lies behind difficult ridges and long stretches of featureless white. Rare, uncertain reports describe enormous pale figures and tracks that disappear into storms. The basin is not a public attraction or a confirmed creature enclosure. Reaching it requires an actual discovery or reliable directions, followed by serious preparation. Its isolation supports quiet ecological observation and the possibility of an encounter with something most residents know only through disputed accounts.

The White Silence - Unmarked Saddle

A difficult saddle opens into a basin without maintained markers. The route back can become hard to distinguish in poor light. Entering it should follow actual discovery and preparation, not an unsolicited shortcut from town.

The White Silence - Deep Basin

Snow and pale stone flatten distance across a broad quiet hollow. Wind can erase tracks rapidly. Large impressions may support cautious inference, but the observer must examine them before identifying their maker.

The White Silence - Wind-Carved Recess

A deep recess in the rock offers evidence of occasional shelter. Its current occupant, if any, is not visible from the approach. A traveler can withdraw rather than press a rare creature into confrontation.

The White Silence - Return Ridge

A narrow ridge provides a potential line back toward known terrain. Changing cloud makes navigation demanding. Leaving with notes or an uncertain sighting can be a complete expedition outcome without killing anything.

54. Stormscar Observatory

Initially known

The ruins of an old weather and signal station stand on an exposed ridge. Its damaged roof, corroded instruments and shattered observation shutters record years of storms and deferred upkeep. It was a practical mountain station, not an advanced magical academy hidden outside the city. Researchers may examine old records, compare measurements or assess a limited restoration. Lightning scars give the place its name; they do not prove that the gray guardian deliberately destroyed it.

Stormscar Observatory - Broken Signal Court

Stone mounts and damaged signal fittings occupy a wind-scoured court. The old road reaches this point before narrowing. Remaining hardware can be studied without assuming it is still operational.

Stormscar Observatory - Instrument Room

Bent frames and corroded measuring devices lie under a partly intact roof. Labels and wear reveal their original purposes. A usable component requires inspection and lawful recovery, not automatic restoration by touch.

Stormscar Observatory - Observation Shutter

A high opening faces the ranges behind a damaged movable shutter. Wind and ice make the mechanism unreliable. Clear weather offers a useful survey view, while a storm makes lingering hazardous.

Stormscar Observatory - Records Niche

A protected stone cupboard contains whatever records have actually survived damp and neglect. Dates and missing pages matter. Findings should support specific conclusions rather than reveal a complete secret history of every dragon.

55. First Shelter Ruins

Initially unknown

Old retaining walls and hearth traces survive in a sheltered fold associated with the city's earliest refugees. The precise approach is no longer part of the ordinary visitor route, though the founding tradition is widely known. Finding and assessing the site can illuminate how the first inhabitants survived before the mine settlement and fortress developed. Its importance is human history and dragon protection, not a hoard placed for adventurers. A credible identification may interest the sanctuary and local families.

First Shelter Ruins - Hidden Approach

A narrow route between weathered rock and old snow leads toward low masonry. It is easy to miss without a lead or careful exploration. Discovering it reveals a site, not immediate certainty about every event that happened there.

First Shelter Ruins - Hearth Remains

Darkened stone and a shallow hearth survive beneath a protective overhang. Their placement suggests practical shelter from wind. Careful recording can preserve information that careless digging would destroy.

First Shelter Ruins - Retaining Wall

An early wall holds a small level space against the slope. Repairs from different periods complicate its dating. Its modest construction contrasts with the huge fortress built by later generations.

First Shelter Ruins - Weathered Memorial

A worn marker preserves fragments of a remembrance near the shelters. Reading it requires patience and comparison with other evidence. A partial inscription need not supply a new prophecy or the guardian's secret name.

56. The Old Offering Steps

Initially known

A maintained but weather-sensitive stair climbs to a broad ledge used for offerings beyond the bustle of the city. Food is placed with care and removed when necessary; sacred practice does not excuse waste or dangerous accumulation. People come to give thanks, pray or look over the ranges. Living dragons occasionally accept offerings or leave gifts, but no one can summon a visit by following a shopping list. The steps are not a route to a known lair.

The Old Offering Steps - Lower Rest

A low wall and bench give visitors a place to check conditions before the climb. Keepers may post notices after heavy weather. Turning back does not signify impiety or failure of a quest.

The Old Offering Steps - Offering Stair

Stone steps follow a sheltered part of the rock, with exposed sections higher up. Snow clearance is practical work. The climb can be quiet and reflective without producing an omen at every turn.

The Old Offering Steps - Open Ledge

A broad ledge faces the high ranges, with a designated place for accepted offerings. Nothing guarantees a dragon will appear while visitors wait. Personal prayers and silence can be the whole purpose of a visit.

The Old Offering Steps - Keepers' Cache

A small secured shelter holds cleaning tools and maintenance supplies. Its contents support the site rather than serve as gifts to travelers. Reports of unusual finds can be left for the responsible keepers.

57. Coldglass Galleries

Initially unknown

A little-known branching cavern system holds pale crystal growths beneath layers of frost and mineral film. Light behaves strangely across the surfaces without making every reflection an illusion spell. The galleries offer mineral study and difficult exploration, with narrow crossings and meltwater complicating return. Discovery does not imply an established commercial claim or safe working route. A prepared expedition can bring back observations and carefully permitted samples without turning the cave into an inexhaustible crystal store. Crystal moths gather around cold mineral light; an unstable magical ice pocket can support an elemental. The split crossing and meltwater chamber remain slick and unstable even when the galleries are quiet.

Coldglass Galleries - Frost Mouth

A narrow opening admits cold air and reveals only the nearest rock. Ice at the threshold changes with conditions outside. Entry requires actual discovery and a means to navigate back, not merely a map label.

Coldglass Galleries - Mirror Gallery

Thin mineral surfaces scatter lamplight into overlapping reflections. The effect is physically disorienting but not automatically hostile magic. Marking the real route can be more useful than attacking every apparent movement.

Coldglass Galleries - Split Crossing

A fracture divides a passage above darker depth. Stable anchor points and the party's actual methods determine whether it can be crossed. A failed approach can lead to retreat rather than an obligatory fall. Crystal moths gather around cold mineral light; an unstable magical ice pocket can support an elemental. The split crossing and meltwater chamber remain slick and unstable even when the galleries are quiet.

Coldglass Galleries - Meltwater Chamber

Slow water collects beneath crystal-bearing walls. Its depth and quality need assessment before use. Samples taken responsibly may support research, while reckless removal can obscure the very structures being studied.

58. The Fallen Pass Shrine

Initially unknown

A small dragon-and-ancestor shrine on a disused pass has partly collapsed under snow and shifting stone. Its former approach is no longer clearly marked, so travelers usually learn of it through an old account or careful exploration. The site reflects the same regional faith as the capital, expressed by people who once used this route. Restoration, historical comparison or recovery of a family memorial can provide meaningful work. The ruin need not contain a curse or a forgotten rival religion.

The Fallen Pass Shrine - Lost Path

Traces of paving disappear beneath snow and fallen stone. Following them requires an actual lead or exploration. The route can reveal old travel habits without opening an unbounded new map.

The Fallen Pass Shrine - Broken Porch

A collapsed porch shelters fragments of carved wood and stone. Snow load has changed the remaining roof's balance. Entry should follow inspection rather than an assumption that all ruins are stable.

The Fallen Pass Shrine - Shrine Chamber

A modest chamber contains weathered dragon imagery and memorial niches. Its style connects it with the capital's faith. Quiet study can establish that link without revealing a new magical school or deity.

The Fallen Pass Shrine - Old Waymarker

A fallen marker near the shrine once directed travelers across the pass. Its surviving faces may help reconstruct a route. It does not establish that the route remains safe or legally open today.

59. Rimefang Ravine

Initially known

A deep ravine cuts between rocky shoulders beyond the easier trails. Ice forms along shaded walls while wind funnels through the gap. The crossing and exposed strata attract prepared surveyors, collectors and travelers with a specific reason to be here. An old bridge site and alternative ledges create route choices, each with visible limitations. The ravine can host territorial wildlife, but its depth, weather and unstable footing are already substantial challenges without constant combat. Predators can use the lower gravel bar and narrow traverse to hem in prey. Broken crossings and exposed rock constrain a fight; an actual observation of the route can reveal a safer passage.

Rimefang Ravine - Bridge Remains

Stone abutments and a few surviving fixtures mark an old crossing. The gap between them is real, and remnants do not constitute a usable bridge. Surveying possible anchors can be a task of its own.

Rimefang Ravine - Narrow Traverse

A ledge runs along one wall before turning out of sight. Ice and loose fragments alter its reliability. Travelers need to assess the next section rather than assume the visible beginning proves a complete route.

Rimefang Ravine - Exposed Strata

Layered rock reveals mineral seams where erosion has cut deep. Observation can be made from safer positions before collection is considered. Breaking the wall carelessly may damage both footing and the material sought.

Rimefang Ravine - Lower Gravel Bar

A difficult descent reaches a small gravel bar beside seasonal water. The space offers clues washed down from above, not guaranteed treasure. Rising water or falling debris can make remaining here unwise. Predators can use the lower gravel bar and narrow traverse to hem in prey. Broken crossings and exposed rock constrain a fight; an actual observation of the route can reveal a safer passage.